Unilateral Divorce and the Marriage Market: Evidence from India's Triple Talaq Ban

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Last edited: November 5, 2026

Abstract

Divorce reform can affect whether existing marriages survive, who enters marriage, and outcomes within newly formed marriages. We study India's ban and September 2018 criminalization of triple talaq, an instantaneous form of divorce historically available to Muslim husbands. Using nationally representative surveys and marriage histories, we compare changes among Muslim women with those among non-Muslim women in a difference-in-differences framework. Among marriages formed before the reform, formal divorce declines, and the composition of surviving marriages shifts toward women who married at ages 12–17 and toward couples with husbands at least five years older. Women in these marriages also report less say over their husbands' earnings. Turning to marriage formation, entry into first marriage declines most clearly among girls aged 12–17 who have not completed primary school. Together, these patterns suggest that restricting husbands' unilateral exit may increase the survival of existing marriages involving vulnerable women while making prospective husbands less willing to marry them. Before marriage, husbands can avoid the future exit restriction by declining to marry. Among marriages formed after the reform, we find lower divorce and suggestive evidence of increased participation in household decisions and reduced emotional intimate partner violence. These findings are consistent with greater commitment within newly formed marriages.

JEL Classification: J12, K36, J16, O12

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1 Introduction

Marriage is a central economic and social institution. It shapes labor supply, savings, fertility, and the distribution of resources within the household (Becker, 1981; Greenwood et al., 2017). The rules governing marital exit can therefore shape economic decisions and relationships within marriage. Much of the literature studies reforms that expand access to divorce, with differing consequences for women (Stevenson and Wolfers, 2006; Brassiolo, 2016; Voena, 2015; García-Ramos, 2021; Corradini and Buccione, 2023). Less is known about the consequences of restricting divorce, particularly when the restriction applies to one spouse while leaving the other's access unchanged.

This paper studies India's ban and September 2018 criminalization of *triple talaq*, an instantaneous and irrevocable form of unilateral divorce historically available to Muslim husbands. The reform invalidated this instantaneous route and made its attempted use a criminal offense, without broadly rewriting Muslim family law.

Restricting husbands' unilateral exit protects women against the dissolution of marriages they may wish to continue, without directly changing their own ability to leave. This protection can affect both which existing marriages remain intact and spouses' behavior within them. Before marriage, the reform can change the attractiveness of marriage for each partner, potentially affecting whether, when, and whom they marry. These potential effects motivate examining marital survival, entry into marriage, and women's experiences within newly formed marriages together.

The reform applied specifically to Muslim marriages, allowing us to compare changes among Muslim women with those among non-Muslim women in a difference-in-differences framework. We first examine marriages formed before the reform, asking whether divorce and the composition of the remaining married population changed differently across the two groups. We then examine whether entry into first marriage changed after the reform. Finally, we compare outcomes and characteristics of marriages formed before and after the reform among Muslims, relative to the corresponding differences among non-Muslims. To-

gether, these comparisons capture adjustment through marital exit, marriage entry, and the marriages formed under the new regime.

We use nationally representative data from the 2015–16 and 2019–21 National Family Health Surveys. These surveys provide information on marriage histories, marital status, spouse characteristics, women's participation in household decisions, and intimate partner violence. Retrospective marriage histories allow us to reconstruct entry into first marriage, including women who remain unmarried.

Our three analyses are closely related. The comparison group for outcomes among new marriages consists of marriages formed before the reform, some of which are observed afterward. The reform may therefore affect which of these earlier marriages remain intact and women's experiences within them. We begin by examining these pre-reform marriages, before turning to marriage entry and outcomes among newly formed marriages.

Among marriages that predate the reform, formal divorce is estimated to decline by 0.082 percentage points among Muslim women relative to non-Muslim women, equivalent to 10.4 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. Among marriages that survive, the composition shifts toward women who began cohabitation at ages 12–17. Their share increases by 3.0 percentage points, equivalent to 13.5 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. The share with husbands at least five years older also increases. Women in these marriages report less say over their husbands' earnings. We use vulnerability to refer to limited economic opportunities and influence within marriage. Early marriage and limited schooling are potential indicators of these constraints.

We next examine whether greater protection within marriage also affects entry into first marriage. Across women aged 12–30, the estimated decline in the quarterly probability of first marriage among Muslims relative to non-Muslims is 0.182 percentage points, equivalent to 7.0 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. We examine marriage entry across three age groups—12–17, 18–24, and 25–30—and separately by primary completion. The clearest evidence of a decline occurs among girls aged 12–17 without primary completion: 0.474

percentage points per quarter, or 18.2 percent of their pre-reform Muslim mean. Together, these findings suggest that greater protection against husbands' unilateral exit may increase the survival of existing marriages involving vulnerable women while making prospective husbands less willing to marry them. The decline in marriage entry among girls aged 12–17 without primary completion is consistent with this response: before marriage, prospective husbands can avoid the future exit restriction by declining to enter these marriages.

Among marriages formed after the reform, Muslim women are 0.4 percentage points less likely to be divorced relative to the corresponding difference among non-Muslims, equivalent to 44.2 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. We also find suggestive evidence of increased participation in household decisions and reduced emotional intimate partner violence. The estimated increase in participation in at least one decision is 4.2 percentage points, approximately 5 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean, while the estimated decline in emotional violence is 4.9 percentage points, approximately 46 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. The clearest evidence of a decline in entry is among young women without primary schooling, while marriage characteristics are measured conditional on having married and describe a broader group of women. Among these women, we find a small, imprecise increase in primary completion and limited changes in other observed characteristics. The decision-making and emotional-violence findings are consistent with greater commitment within newly formed marriages.

We contribute to research on divorce rights and women's outcomes by examining protection against husbands' instantaneous unilateral exit while wives' access to divorce remains unchanged. Previous studies examine how expanded access to divorce affects violence and bargaining (Stevenson and Wolfers, 2006; Brassiolo, 2016; García-Ramos, 2021), as well as household saving and marriage-specific investment (Stevenson, 2007; González and Özcan, 2013; Voena, 2015). García-Ramos (2021) finds no significant average effect of Mexico's unilateral divorce reform on intimate partner violence, but an increase of about 20 percent relative to baseline six to eight years later. Corradini and Buccione (2023) find that

expanding women's unilateral divorce rights in Egypt reduced past-year physical abuse by approximately 7 percentage points, or 58 percent of the pre-reform mean. We examine a third change: restricting husbands' instantaneous unilateral exit while leaving wives' access to divorce unchanged, and find suggestive evidence of reduced emotional violence among newly formed marriages. Together, these studies motivate distinguishing whose exit option changes. Greater protection within marriage can arise from strengthening women's ability to leave or limiting husbands' ability to dissolve a marriage their wives may wish to continue. Expanding access to divorce for both spouses can therefore have different implications than expanding access for women alone or restricting husbands' exit.

Our analysis also builds on research linking divorce law to marriage formation and selection (Rasul, 2006). Studies in developed countries examine how changes in marital rights affect existing couples and the formation and composition of new partnerships (Matouschek and Rasul, 2008; Chiappori et al., 2017; Reynoso, 2024). We extend this literature to a developing-country setting where early marriage and limited schooling may constrain women's economic opportunities outside marriage. These constraints can shape both the value of legal protection within marriage and the adjustments that occur before couples marry. Studying marital survival, marriage formation, and outcomes within marriage together allows us to examine how marital rights operate under these conditions.

Finally, we contribute to research on family law and women's status in South Asia by providing nationally representative quasi-experimental evidence on India's *triple talaq* reform. Ambrus et al. (2010) examine how changes in husbands' divorce costs affect marriage contracts and payments in Bangladesh, while Calvi and Keskar (2026) study how Indian antidowry reforms affect separation, bargaining, and violence. We complement this work by examining a direct restriction on husbands' instantaneous unilateral divorce, tracing its consequences for marital survival, marriage formation, and women's experiences within marriage. Our analysis also complements legal and descriptive research on Muslim women's rights and the *triple talaq* debate with evidence on the reform's effects (Narain, 1998; Agnes,

2017; Niaz and Soman, 2015; Wommelsdorff, 2021).

2 Background and Conceptual Framework

2.1 Triple Talaq and the Reform

Historically, *triple talaq* allowed a Muslim husband to end a marriage instantaneously and irrevocably by saying "talaq" three times in immediate succession, without requiring his wife's consent (Supreme Court of India, 2017). Wives did not have an equivalent instantaneous exit option, although they could seek divorce through other legal routes, including judicial dissolution under the Dissolution of Muslim Marriages Act, 1939 (Government of India, 1939). The reform targeted this particular husband-side exit option without broadly rewriting Muslim family law or changing wives' access to divorce.

The legal change occurred in stages. In August 2017, the Supreme Court set aside the practice of *triple talaq* in *Shayara Bano v. Union of India* (Supreme Court of India, 2017). This ruling invalidated the practice but did not make its attempted use a criminal offense. The government cited reports that the practice continued despite the Supreme Court's ruling and argued that additional legal measures were needed to deter its use and protect affected women (Parliament of India, 2019b). Criminal penalties were introduced through an ordinance on September 19, 2018, followed by further ordinances on January 12 and February 21, 2019 (Parliament of India, 2019b). The Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Marriage) Act received presidential assent on July 31, 2019, replacing the ordinance and retaining September 19, 2018 as its commencement date (Parliament of India, 2019a).

Under the reform, an attempted instantaneous divorce is void and illegal and can result in up to three years' imprisonment and a fine. The legislation also provides for subsistence allowance for the wife and dependent children, and custody of minor children as determined by a magistrate. These protections apply even though the attempted divorce does not legally dissolve the marriage (Parliament of India, 2019a). Under Section 7(a), the offense is

cognizable when information is given to the police by the wife or any person related to her by blood or marriage. Reporting therefore does not depend solely on the wife approaching the police (Parliament of India, 2019a,b). Together, these provisions increased the legal costs of attempting instantaneous unilateral exit.

2.2 Conceptual Framework

Restricting husbands' unilateral exit can affect both whether existing marriages continue and whether prospective marriages form. A husband already married faces a higher cost of leaving, while a prospective husband anticipates reduced flexibility to exit in the future. The same restriction may therefore preserve existing marriages while discouraging entry into new ones. The framework connects these decisions and distinguishes changes within marriages from changes in which marriages form or survive.

Let $r \in \{0, 1\}$ index the legal regime, where $r = 0$ is the pre-reform regime and $r = 1$ is the post-reform regime. Let F_r summarize the time, procedural, financial, and expected legal friction associated with the affected husband-side exit route. The reform raises this friction, so $F_1 > F_0$. Divorce remains available through other procedures, but the affected route is no longer instantaneous and is more costly. Below, F denotes a generic level of this friction.

Let q denote a shared component of latent match-specific quality, such as mutual compatibility. It is fixed for a given potential couple: the reform can change the value and outcomes of their marriage, but not their underlying q. Let z collect observed individual, spouse, match, and local characteristics that can affect marriage values, outside values, or match opportunities.

2.2.1 Prospective Marriages and Entry

For a prospective couple, define the woman's and husband's gross values of marriage as

$$V_w(q, z, F) = u_w(q, z) + J_w(q, F) + B(F),$$
$$V_h(q, z, F) = u_h(q, z) + J_h(q, F) + \Omega(q, z, F).$$

Here, $u_j(q, z)$ is spouse j's value from the match apart from the reform-dependent terms. The function $J_j(q, F)$ captures spouse j's payoff from cooperation and marriage-specific investments, including how marital resources are shared. Greater commitment can change these payoffs in either direction. The function $B(F)$ captures the woman's protection from instantaneous abandonment. Finally, $\Omega(q, z, F)$ is the husband's additional expected value from being able to use the affected exit route at a future date if leaving becomes preferable to staying.

Let $A_j(z)$ be spouse j's value outside the relevant marriage, before any exit friction. For prospective spouses it is the value of not entering; for existing spouses below it is the value available after exit. It may differ with z but is held fixed as F changes. This is a simplifying assumption: changes in the pool of potential partners could also change outside values, but we set that feedback aside. The outside value A_h is distinct from Ω, which measures the additional value of a future exit choice and depends on both the outside value and the value of staying. Net surplus from marriage is

$$\Delta_j(q, z, F) = V_j(q, z, F) - A_j(z), \qquad j \in \{w, h\}.$$

A prospective spouse accepts the match when $\Delta_j(q, z, F) \geq 0$. Thus, V_j first describes the value of marriage, while Δ_j compares that value with the relevant outside value.

Let $p(q, z, F) \in [0, 1]$ denote the probability that the husband would use the affected exit route in the future, and let $\delta \in (0, 1)$ be a fixed weight on that future decision. Write

$J_{jF} \equiv \partial J_j(q, F)/\partial F$. Appendix Section F.1 describes a simple future-exit decision that gives

$$\Omega_F(q, z, F) = -\delta p(q, z, F)(1 + J_{hF}).$$

The higher friction makes future exit more expensive, while a change in the value of staying also changes how useful the exit option is. In particular, a decline in J_h makes the option more useful and can offset the direct cost effect.

We assume that protection raises the woman's value of marriage, $B'(F) > 0$, and offsets any decline in her other marital payoffs, so $J_{wF} + B'(F) \geq 0$. Because the outside values are fixed with respect to F,

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial \Delta_w(q, z, F)}{\partial F} &= J_{wF} + B'(F) \geq 0, \\
\frac{\partial \Delta_h(q, z, F)}{\partial F} &= (1 - \delta p(q, z, F))J_{hF} - \delta p(q, z, F) \gtrless 0.
\end{aligned}$$

Under the net-benefit assumption, the woman's surplus does not fall. For the husband, the response depends on both within-marriage payoffs and future exit flexibility. His entry surplus falls if $J_{hF} < 0$, while a sufficiently large positive response in J_h can outweigh the loss of exit flexibility and raise his surplus.

Holding z and F fixed, we assume that higher match quality raises each spouse's value of marriage. Because outside values do not depend on this match-specific component, it also raises each spouse's net surplus: $\partial \Delta_j/\partial q = \partial V_j/\partial q > 0$. Let $q_w(F, z)$ and $q_h(F, z)$ be the match-quality cutoffs at which each partner is just willing to marry. Their responses are

$$\frac{\partial q_j(F, z)}{\partial F} = -\frac{\partial \Delta_j(q, z, F)/\partial F}{\partial \Delta_j(q, z, F)/\partial q}.$$

The nonnegative woman-side surplus effect implies $\partial q_w/\partial F \leq 0$: women are at least as willing to accept a given match. The husband-side cutoff can either rise or fall because $\partial \Delta_h/\partial F$ is ambiguous. A marriage forms only if both partners accept the match, so the

relevant joint cutoff is

$$q^*(F, z) = \max\{q_w(F, z), q_h(F, z)\}.$$

At age a, the marriage hazard for women of type z can be written as

$$\lambda_{az}(F) = m_{az}(F) \left[1 - \Phi_{az}\big(q^*(F, z)\big)\right],$$

where $m_{az}(F)$ is the rate at which potential matches arrive and Φ_{az} is the distribution of offered match quality. The term in brackets is the share of offered matches that meet both participation constraints. The hazard rises if matches arrive more often or if the joint cutoff falls, and it falls if match opportunities decline or if the joint cutoff rises. Neither the husband's acceptance response nor the change in match arrivals has a predetermined sign, so the effect on entry is ambiguous. Holding outside values and the number and quality of potential matches fixed, a decline in the hazard requires the joint cutoff to rise. Under the woman's net-benefit assumption, her cutoff does not rise, so any such increase must come from the husband-side cutoff. A decline can instead reflect fewer potential matches, which the empirical analysis cannot separately identify. Appendix Section F.1 derives the option-value, cutoff, and hazard comparative statics.

When a decline is caused by a higher joint cutoff, the matches that still form have higher average q within the affected type z. This implication applies only to a group for which entry declines through the cutoff channel. It does not follow from a decline caused by fewer match opportunities, nor does a higher average q mechanically imply an improvement in any particular observed characteristic in z.

2.2.2 Existing Marriages and the Surviving Stock

Once a marriage exists, however, reaching the outside option requires divorce. The husband's net value from current exit is therefore $A_h(z) - F$. He compares this value with the value of

continuing the marriage, $V_h(q, z, F)$. Define his continuation surplus as

$$\begin{aligned} S(q, z, F) &= V_h(q, z, F) - [A_h(z) - F] \\ &= \Delta_h(q, z, F) + F. \end{aligned}$$

The friction F enters positively because it lowers the value of exiting, making continuation relatively more attractive. The marriage remains observed when $S(q, z, F) \geq 0$. When $S(q, z, F) < 0$, the husband pursues divorce through an available procedure. Divorce therefore remains possible even under the higher friction.

Using the prospective-marriage value above,

$$\frac{\partial S(q, z, F)}{\partial F} = 1 + \frac{\partial \Delta_h(q, z, F)}{\partial F} = (1 - \delta p(q, z, F))(1 + J_{hF}).$$

Because $1 - \delta p > 0$, continuation surplus weakly rises when $J_{hF} \geq -1$. This condition allows the husband's within-marriage payoff to fall, but not enough for the decline in the value of staying to outweigh the higher cost of leaving. Under this condition, an increase in F can keep some existing marriages intact that would have dissolved under the lower friction. If the deterioration is larger, the reform can instead make continuation less attractive.

The distinction between entry and continuation is central. Before marriage, a husband can avoid the future exit restriction by declining to marry. Once married, leaving requires bearing the higher exit cost. Consequently, the reform can make an existing marriage more likely to continue even when it makes entering that marriage less attractive.

The match-quality assumption above also implies $S_q(q, z, F) = V_{hq}(q, z, F) > 0$. For a given z, let $q^S(F, z)$ be the match quality at which the husband is indifferent between continuing and exiting:

$$S\big(q^S(F, z), z, F\big) = 0.$$

Marriages with $q \geq q^S(F, z)$ remain observed. Under the continuation condition $J_{hF} \geq -1$,

the implicit-function theorem gives

$$\frac{\partial q^S(F,z)}{\partial F} = -\frac{S_F(q,z,F)}{S_q(q,z,F)} \leq 0.$$

The reform therefore weakly lowers the minimum match quality required for an existing marriage to remain observed. When the cutoff falls, the newly retained marriages lie between the post- and pre-reform cutoffs and have lower q than marriages that would have remained observed under the old regime.

Let the average outcome among existing marriages that remain observed be

$$\bar{Y}^S(F) = \mathbb{E}\left[y(q,F,z) \mid S(q,z,F) \geq 0\right].$$

Its change has two components:

$$\frac{d\bar{Y}^S(F)}{dF} = \underbrace{\text{within-marriage effect}}_{\text{behavior changes in a given marriage}} + \underbrace{\text{survivor-selection effect}}_{\text{which existing marriages remain observed}}.$$

For characteristics fixed when the marriage formed, such as age at marriage and the initial spousal age gap, the within-marriage effect is zero. Their observed changes therefore reflect survivor selection. Outcomes that can change after marriage, such as decision-making and intimate partner violence, can reflect both behavior within surviving marriages and changes in which marriages remain observed. The framework does not assign a sign to every observed characteristic; that sign depends on how the characteristic is related to continuation surplus. Appendix Section F.2 gives the exact survivor-selection derivative.

2.2.3 New-Marriage Outcomes

Among marriages that form, the average outcome is

$$\bar{Y}^N(F) = \mathbb{E}\left[y(q,F,z) \mid q \geq q^*(F,z)\right].$$

This expectation is taken over the matches available under F, so the composition of both q and z can differ across regimes. An observed change in this average has two components:

$$\frac{d\bar{Y}^N(F)}{dF} = \underbrace{\text{within-marriage effect}}_{\text{behavior changes in a given marriage}} + \underbrace{\text{entry-selection effect}}_{\text{changing which matches form}}.$$

Once a new marriage forms, it faces the same higher husband-side exit friction as an existing marriage. What distinguishes a new-marriage cohort is that its members also entered under the post-reform participation constraints. Its outcomes therefore combine the within-marriage response to the law with entry selection.

The two components have different implications across outcomes. For a characteristic fixed when a marriage forms, the within-marriage effect is zero. A change in its cohort mean therefore reflects a change in the composition of marriages that form. Outcomes determined after entry can reflect both a within-match response to the reform and entry selection. For divorce, the higher exit friction delays or discourages affected exits for a given match under the same continuation condition used for existing marriages; entry selection may reinforce or offset this effect. Holding the match fixed does not hold its value fixed, so the condition matters for both cohorts. Intimate partner violence and decision-making can also change through both channels, but the framework does not impose a sign on their within-marriage responses. Fixed-at-entry characteristics can nevertheless help interpret these results. If the post-reform cohort is less advantaged on observed characteristics associated with worse marital outcomes, while marital outcomes improve, observed entry selection works against rather than explains the improvement. This pattern therefore supports a favorable within-marriage response. Appendix Section F.3 provides the exact decomposition.

2.2.4 Empirical Implications

The framework yields four empirical implications:

1. *Marriage entry.* Under the woman's net-benefit assumption and fixed outside val-

ues, her acceptance cutoff does not rise. The husband's response and the change in match opportunities are ambiguous, so the marriage hazard has no predetermined sign. Holding the number and quality of potential matches fixed, a cutoff-driven decline for a particular group must come from the husband side.

2. *Exit among existing marriages.* Under the continuation condition $J_{hF} \geq -1$, a higher F weakly raises continuation surplus and delays or discourages affected exits. Divorce should therefore weakly decline among pre-reform marriages to the extent that this route contributes to observed dissolution.

3. *Survivor selection.* Under the same condition, the continuation cutoff weakly falls. When it falls, the reform retains some lower-q existing marriages for longer. Fixed-at-marriage characteristics change only through survivor selection, while post-marriage outcomes can also reflect behavior within surviving unions.

4. *Outcomes among new marriages.* New-marriage outcomes combine within-match responses with entry selection. Under the same continuation condition, the higher exit friction delays or discourages affected divorces for a given match; entry selection may reinforce or offset this effect. The framework does not impose a sign on the within-marriage effects on intimate partner violence or decision-making. Changes in fixed-at-entry characteristics reveal observed selection; improvements that occur despite adverse observed selection support a favorable within-marriage response.

3 Empirical Strategy

We examine how restricting husbands' unilateral exit affects existing marriages, entry into marriage, and outcomes within marriages formed under the new legal regime. We use three related designs, each comparing Muslim women with non-Muslim women. The first examines changes across the reform in dissolution and in the characteristics and experiences of women

whose pre-reform marriages remain intact. The second examines changes in the quarterly probability of entering first marriage. The third compares outcomes across marriage cohorts formed before and after the reform.

A potential concern across these designs is that changes in Muslims' economic circumstances around the reform could also affect marriage outcomes. Using the Periodic Labour Force Survey, we find no evidence of a broad deterioration in Muslim men's employment or earnings relative to non-Muslim men (Appendix Table D19).

3.1 Pre-Reform Marriages

We first examine marriages formed before the reform. We study dissolution among ever-married women, including those whose marriages have ended, and then examine the characteristics and experiences of women whose marriages remain intact. These analyses distinguish changes in marital exit from changes in the population that remains married.

We compare outcomes observed before and after the reform among Muslim women with the corresponding changes among non-Muslim women. We estimate:

$$Y_{istw} = \beta(Muslim_i \times Post_w) + \lambda_r + \lambda_t + \lambda_s + \lambda_w + \lambda_{s\times w} + \varepsilon_{istw}.$$

Here, Y_{istw} denotes the outcome for woman i, in state s, whose marriage began in year t, observed in survey period w. Depending on the analysis, the outcome measures marital dissolution, a characteristic of surviving marriages, or women's experiences within those marriages. $Muslim_i$ equals one for Muslim women, and $Post_w$ equals one when the woman is observed after the reform. Thus, treatment timing refers to when outcomes are observed; the marriages themselves began before the reform.

The coefficient of interest, β, measures the change among Muslim women relative to the corresponding change among non-Muslim women. Its causal interpretation requires that, absent the reform, these outcomes would have evolved in parallel across the two groups,

conditional on the included fixed effects.

Religion, marriage-year, state, and survey-period fixed effects account for persistent differences across religious groups, differences across marriage cohorts and states, and common changes between survey periods. State-by-survey-period fixed effects additionally allow changes between periods to differ across states. For decision-making and intimate partner violence, we also include years-since-marriage fixed effects.

Among currently married women, changes in characteristics fixed at marriage capture changes in the composition of surviving marriages. Changes in decision-making and intimate partner violence can reflect both this composition and changes within marriages.

3.2 Marriage Entry

Greater protection within marriage may also affect prospective spouses' willingness to marry. We therefore examine whether the reform changes entry into first marriage. We follow women at risk of first marriage over ages 12–30. The lower bound includes early adolescent marriage, while the upper bound captures an age by which marriage is nearly universal.[1]

We organize the analysis around quarters in which a woman has not yet married at the start of the quarter. The outcome equals one if she enters her first marriage during that quarter and zero otherwise. We compare changes in this quarterly probability among Muslim women with corresponding changes among non-Muslim women. Following Corno et al. (2020), we estimate a discrete-time first-marriage hazard:

$$H_{iaqsb} = \beta(Muslim_i \times Post_q) + \lambda_r + \lambda_s + \lambda_b + \lambda_{s\times b} + \lambda_a + \lambda_{\text{season}(q)} + \varepsilon_{iaqsb}.$$

Here, H_{iaqsb} is the first-marriage indicator for woman i, at age a at the start of calendar quarter q, in state s, and born in year b. $Muslim_i$ equals one for Muslim women. $Post_q$ equals one from 2018 Q4 onward, the first full quarter after the September 2018 reform. We

[1] In our data, 96.4 percent of women aged 30 at interview have already entered marriage.

omit 2018 Q3 because it contains months both before and after the reform.

The coefficient of interest, β, measures the change in Muslim women's quarterly probability of first marriage relative to the corresponding change among non-Muslim women. Its causal interpretation requires that, absent the reform, marriage probabilities would have evolved in parallel across the two groups, conditional on the included fixed effects.

Religion, state, and birth-year fixed effects account for persistent differences across religious groups, states, and birth cohorts. State-by-birth-year fixed effects allow differences across birth cohorts to vary by state. Age fixed effects account for differences in marriage probabilities across ages, while quarter-of-year fixed effects account for seasonal patterns in marriage formation.

Alongside the overall estimate, we estimate separate effects for the mutually exclusive age groups 12–17, 18–24, and 25–30. Within each age group, we also estimate separate effects for women with and without primary completion.

3.3 Outcomes among New Marriages

We next examine outcomes among marriages formed before and after the reform. We study marital dissolution, the characteristics of the marriages that form, and women's decision-making and experiences of intimate partner violence. We compare differences between Muslim marriage cohorts formed before and after September 2018 with the corresponding differences among non-Muslim marriage cohorts.

We estimate:

$$Y_{istw} = \beta(Muslim_i \times Post) + \lambda_r + \lambda_s + \lambda_t + \lambda_w + \lambda_{s\times t} + \varepsilon_{istw}.$$

Here, Y_{istw} denotes the outcome for woman i, in state s, whose marriage began in year t, observed in survey period w. $Muslim_i$ equals one for Muslim women, and $Post$ equals one if the marriage began in September 2018 or later. In this design, treatment status therefore

depends on when the marriage formed.

The coefficient of interest, β, measures the difference between post- and pre-reform Muslim marriage cohorts relative to the corresponding difference among non-Muslims. Its causal interpretation requires that, absent the reform, outcomes would have evolved similarly across Muslim and non-Muslim marriage cohorts, conditional on the included fixed effects.

Religion, state, marriage-year, and survey-period fixed effects account for persistent differences across religious groups and states, differences across marriage cohorts, and common differences between observation periods. State-by-marriage-year fixed effects additionally allow cohort differences to vary across states. For decision-making and intimate partner violence, we also include years-since-marriage fixed effects.

Some marriages in the comparison group were formed before the reform but observed afterward. As discussed in the pre-reform-marriage analysis in Section 3.1, the reform may affect both which existing marriages remain intact and women's experiences within them. These changes could therefore affect the comparison with newly formed marriages. To address this concern, we repeat the analyses of decision-making, intimate partner violence, and marriage characteristics using only earlier marriages observed before the reform as the comparison group (Appendix Tables D14–D18).

Because the reform may affect which marriages form, changes in outcomes among newly formed marriages can reflect both selection into marriage and changes within marriage. We therefore examine marriage characteristics alongside dissolution and women's experiences.

Across all designs, regressions use the appropriate NFHS survey weights and standard errors clustered at the state level (35 clusters).

4 Data

Our data come from the National Family Health Survey (NFHS), India's Demographic and Health Survey. We use NFHS-4, conducted in 2015–16, and NFHS-5, conducted in 2019–21.

Both surveys provide nationally representative information on women aged 15–49, including marriage histories, education, employment, spouse characteristics, household decision-making, and intimate partner violence.

We measure marriage formation using the reported month and year of first cohabitation. In India, first cohabitation is a close proxy for marriage formation: premarital sex is uncommon and premarital childbearing is very rare (Edmeades et al., 2020). Throughout the empirical analysis, references to marriage timing therefore refer to the beginning of first cohabitation.

4.1 Pre-Reform Marriages

The dissolution analysis includes women who are currently or formerly married. We use all ever-married women in NFHS-4 and ever-married women in NFHS-5 whose first cohabitation began before September 2018. NFHS-4 does not report first-cohabitation timing for formerly married women. We therefore retain these women using a common category for unavailable marriage year and impose no lower bound on marriage year for this analysis.

To examine the characteristics and experiences of women in surviving pre-reform marriages, we restrict the sample to currently married women whose first cohabitation began between January 2012 and August 2018. We observe these marriage cohorts across the two survey rounds. This sample includes only marriages that remain intact when women are interviewed, allowing us to examine changes in the composition and reported experiences of the surviving married population.

4.2 First-Marriage Histories

The marriage-entry analysis uses NFHS-5, which records first-cohabitation timing for both currently and formerly married women. We also include never-married women. Using each woman's reported birth, first-cohabitation, and interview dates, we reconstruct her quarterly history of exposure to first marriage over ages 12–30.

Women contribute observations while they remain unmarried, beginning with the first quarter in which they are aged 12 at its start. Their histories end in the quarter of first marriage or, for those who remain unmarried, at the last eligible quarter before interview. Age is measured at the beginning of each quarter, and quarters beginning after age 30 are excluded. The outcome equals one in the quarter of first marriage and zero in preceding quarters. We omit the third quarter of 2018, which includes both pre- and post-reform months.[2]

4.3 Outcomes among New Marriages

We study marriages whose first cohabitation began in January 2012 or later. Marriages beginning before September 2018 form the pre-reform cohorts, and those beginning in September 2018 or later form the post-reform cohorts. We observe pre-reform cohorts in both NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, while post-reform cohorts are observed in NFHS-5.

The dissolution analysis includes currently and formerly married women and uses NFHS-5 only, because NFHS-4 does not report first-cohabitation dates for formerly married women. For marriage characteristics, household decision-making, and intimate partner violence, we use both surveys and include women with the information required for each outcome.

The emotional, physical, and sexual IPV outcomes are indicators equal to one if the respondent reports ever having experienced the corresponding form of intimate partner violence. Estimation samples vary across outcomes because some information is collected only in particular survey modules.

[2]Women must be unmarried and eligible by age at the start of a quarter. An initial partial quarter is excluded if a woman's twelfth birthday falls in its second or third month. Quarters without a marriage are retained only when all three months are observed; the quarter of first marriage is retained even if marriage occurs before its final month. A quarter beginning at age 30 remains eligible through its end even if the woman turns 31 during it. The narrower age samples use the same age-at-quarter-start rule. A first marriage in the omitted third quarter of 2018 still ends the woman's history, so she does not re-enter the risk set in the fourth quarter.

5 Results

The results are organized around the three empirical exercises in Section 3. We first study marital exit among pre-reform marriages and then the stock of those marriages observed among currently married women. We next estimate the first-marriage hazard using a quarterly panel constructed from retrospective histories, and then turn to outcomes among marriages formed around the reform.

5.1 Pre-Reform Marriages

Among marriages formed before the reform, we ask two questions. First, did formal marital exit change after the reform? Second, did the composition of pre-reform marriages that remained intact change? The first analysis includes all available ever-married women whose marriages predate the reform. The second restricts attention to currently married women whose first cohabitation began between January 2012 and August 2018 and compares the characteristics of this surviving married population before and after the reform.

Divorce and separation are uncommon in India, but affect a substantial number of women. The 2011 Census recorded approximately 910,000 divorced women and 3.28 million divorced or separated women nationwide. In our pre-reform sample, 0.79 percent of Muslim women report being divorced, compared with 0.39 percent of non-Muslim women. This roughly twofold difference is consistent with the Census, which reports corresponding shares of 0.49 and 0.24 percent among ever-married women (Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, India, 2011).[3]

Table 1 shows a relative decline in formal divorce among Muslim women whose marriages predate the reform. The estimated reduction is 0.082 percentage points, equivalent to 10.4 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. The estimate for divorce or separation is also negative, although less precisely estimated.

[3]The Census figures cover women of all ages. The national counts refer to marital status at the time of the Census, while the religious-group percentages use ever-married women within each group as the denominator.

Table 1: Dissolution among Pre-Reform Marriages

	(1) Divorced	(2) Divorced or separated
Muslim × Post	−0.082*	−0.060
	(0.042)	(0.080)
Wild-cluster bootstrap p-value	0.112	0.473
Non-Muslim (pre-reform), percent	0.389	1.358
Non-Muslim (post-reform), percent	0.415	1.470
Muslim (pre-reform), percent	0.787	1.752
Observations	1,043,170	1,043,170

Notes: Standard errors are clustered at the state level (35 clusters) and reported in parentheses. Significance stars are based on conventional state-clustered p-values: $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. We also report wild-cluster bootstrap p-values using 520 replications, clustered by state. The pre-reform survey includes all ever-married women; the post-reform survey includes ever-married women whose first cohabitation began before September 2018. Post indicates observation in the post-reform survey. Coefficients and standard errors are in percentage points and reference means are percentages. Specifications include religion, first-cohabitation-year, and state × survey-wave fixed effects. Women with unavailable marriage years in the pre-reform survey share a common unknown-year category. Regressions use survey weights.

Restricting husbands' unilateral exit may change which existing marriages remain intact. We examine these changes using women's age at marriage and the spousal age gap.

Table 2 examines the characteristics of pre-reform marriages that remain intact. Panel A shows a shift toward marriages formed at younger ages and with larger spousal age gaps. Relative to non-Muslims, Muslim women in these marriages began cohabitation 0.30 years younger—approximately 3.6 months, or 1.5 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. The share with husbands at least five years older increases by 5.7 percentage points, equivalent to 13.6 percent of its pre-reform Muslim mean. The estimate for husbands at least ten years older is also positive, although less precisely estimated.

Panel B examines women's schooling and employment. We restrict primary completion to women who first cohabited at age 12 or older and secondary completion to women who first cohabited at age 18 or older, giving women more opportunity to complete these levels before marriage. Average years of schooling change little. Primary completion increases by 1.0 percentage point, while secondary completion declines by 2.0 percentage points, equivalent to 6.9 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. The wild-cluster bootstrap p-values are 0.054

and 0.031, respectively; the Holm-adjusted p-value is 0.107 for each completion outcome.

The share of women not working increases by 5.3 percentage points, equivalent to 5.7 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean.

Table 2: Characteristics of Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages

Panel A. Age and Match Characteristics

	(1) Age at first cohabitation	(2) Age gap $\geq$ 5 years	(3) Age gap $\geq$ 10 years
Muslim × Post	-0.300^{***}	0.057^{***}	0.019^{*}
	(0.096)	(0.016)	(0.011)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.035	0.008	0.108
Holm-adjusted p	0.007	0.004	0.095
Non-Muslim (Pre-reform)	20.387	0.414	0.087
Non-Muslim (Post-reform)	20.221	0.429	0.099
Muslim (Pre-reform)	20.130	0.420	0.069
Observations	202,666	32,509	32,509

Panel B. Women's Schooling and Employment

	(1) Years of schooling	(2) Primary completed	(3) Secondary completed	(4) Woman not working
Muslim × Post	0.005	0.010^{**}	-0.020^{**}	0.053^{***}
	(0.069)	(0.005)	(0.009)	(0.016)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.919	0.054	0.031	< 0.002
Holm-adjusted p	0.937	0.107	0.107	0.007
Non-Muslim (Pre-reform)	9.320	0.852	0.426	0.888
Non-Muslim (Post-reform)	9.607	0.862	0.469	0.818
Muslim (Pre-reform)	7.755	0.772	0.287	0.929
Observations	202,443	202,408	160,123	32,528

Notes: Standard errors are clustered at the state level (35 clusters) and reported in parentheses. Significance stars use conventional state-clustered p-values: $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. We also report wild-cluster bootstrap p-values using 520 replications, clustered by state; values below 0.002 are reported as < 0.002. Holm-adjusted p-values apply the step-down correction to conventional state-clustered p-values separately across the three outcomes in Panel A and the four outcomes in Panel B.
Currently married women whose first cohabitation began in January 2012–August 2018, observed in the pre-reform or post-reform survey. Post indicates observation in the post-reform survey. Specifications include religion, first-cohabitation-year, and state × survey-wave fixed effects.
Age at first cohabitation and schooling are in years; binary outcomes and reference means are proportions. Age and age gaps describe marriage formation. Schooling and employment are measured at interview. Primary and secondary completion indicate at least five and twelve completed years of schooling, respectively. We restrict the primary completion sample to women who married at age 12 or older and the secondary completion sample to women who married at age 18 or older. Reference means use each column's estimation sample. Regressions use women's survey weights; samples vary by outcome and module.

Table 3 examines the age-at-first-cohabitation distribution underlying the mean-age re-

sult. Relative to non-Muslims, the share of surviving Muslim marriages in which women began cohabitation at ages 12–17 increases by 3.0 percentage points, equivalent to 13.5 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. The estimated changes in the shares first cohabiting at ages 18–24 and 25–30 are negative and imprecisely estimated.

Table 3: Age at First Cohabitation among Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages

	(1) Below 12	(2) Ages 12–17	(3) Ages 18–24	(4) Ages 25–30
Muslim × Post	0.000397*	0.0302**	-0.0174	-0.00942
	(0.000198)	(0.0126)	(0.0112)	(0.00745)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.204	0.023	0.185	0.312
Non-Muslim (Pre-reform)	0.0000251	0.200	0.678	0.109
Non-Muslim (Post-reform)	0.000238	0.232	0.644	0.109
Muslim (Pre-reform)	0.0000428	0.223	0.668	0.0929
Observations	202,666	202,666	202,666	202,666

Notes: Outcomes, coefficients, standard errors, and reference means are proportions. State-clustered standard errors (35 clusters) are in parentheses. Significance stars use conventional state-clustered p-values: $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. The wild-bootstrap row reports state-cluster bootstrap p-values using 520 replications and seed 12345.
The sample comprises currently married women whose first cohabitation began in January 2012–August 2018, observed in NFHS-4 or NFHS-5. Post indicates observation in NFHS-5. Regressions use women's survey weights and religion, first-cohabitation-year, and state × survey-wave fixed effects. Each column uses all 202,666 women, including those first cohabiting at age 31 or older. The Below 12 category contains 36 women.

The composition shifts are consistent with greater retention of women who married young and of marriages with larger spousal age gaps following the restriction on husbands' unilateral exit. We next examine decision-making and intimate partner violence within surviving marriages, where the estimates may reflect both changes in composition and changes within continuing relationships.

Table 4 examines women's decision-making and experiences of intimate partner violence within surviving pre-reform marriages. Panel A shows that, relative to non-Muslims, Muslim women are 5.2 percentage points less likely to participate in decisions over their husbands' earnings, either alone or jointly. This corresponds to an 8.4 percent decline relative to the pre-reform Muslim mean. The estimates for decisions concerning healthcare, large purchases, and visits to relatives are also negative but less precise.

Panel B reports the estimates for emotional, physical, and sexual intimate partner violence. These estimates are mixed in sign and imprecisely estimated, providing no clear evidence of a change in reported violence among women in surviving marriages.

Table 4: Women's Experiences in Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages

Panel A. Household Decision-Making

	(1) Healthcare	(2) Large purchases	(3) Visits to relatives	(4) Husband's earnings	(5) Any decision
Muslim × Post	−0.019	−0.024	−0.032	−0.052***	−0.003
	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.022)	(0.017)	(0.015)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.254	0.165	0.162	0.004	0.838
Holm-adjusted p	0.488	0.488	0.488	0.018	–
Non-Muslim (Pre-reform)	0.694	0.653	0.683	0.641	0.813
Non-Muslim (Post-reform)	0.790	0.762	0.786	0.754	0.884
Muslim (Pre-reform)	0.687	0.643	0.672	0.619	0.789
Observations	31,441	31,441	31,441	31,441	31,441

Panel B. Intimate Partner Violence

	(1) Emotional IPV	(2) Physical IPV	(3) Sexual IPV
Muslim × Post	−0.011	0.001	0.022
	(0.015)	(0.016)	(0.021)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.550	0.954	0.423
Holm-adjusted p	0.907	0.958	0.884
Non-Muslim (Pre-reform)	0.084	0.159	0.044
Non-Muslim (Post-reform)	0.111	0.225	0.044
Muslim (Pre-reform)	0.083	0.144	0.035
Observations	22,902	22,902	22,902

Notes: Standard errors are clustered at the state level (35 clusters) and reported in parentheses. Significance stars use conventional state-clustered p-values: $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. We also report wild-cluster bootstrap p-values using 520 replications, clustered by state; values below 0.002 are reported as < 0.002. Holm-adjusted p-values apply the step-down correction to conventional state-clustered p-values separately across the four individual decision outcomes in Panel A and the three IPV outcomes in Panel B. Any Decision is reported separately as a summary outcome and excluded from the multiple-testing family; its Holm entry is a dash.
Currently married women whose first cohabitation began in January 2012–August 2018, observed in the pre-reform or post-reform survey. Post indicates observation in the post-reform survey. Specifications include religion, first-cohabitation-year, and state × survey-wave fixed effects. Both panels additionally include years-since-marriage fixed effects.
Outcomes and reference means are proportions. Decision-making records participation alone or jointly; Any Decision indicates participation in at least one of the four decisions. IPV measures report ever experiencing the indicated form of violence. Decision-making regressions use women's survey weights; IPV regressions use domestic-violence weights. Samples vary by outcome and module.

The decline in women's say over husbands' earnings may reflect both changes within continuing marriages and the retention of marriages in which women have less influence over household decisions.

Appendix Tables D5–D8 report the complete results under the baseline and alternative fixed-effect specifications.

Restricting the married-stock sample to marriages formed in 2012–2015 yields similar estimates for age at first cohabitation, age gap, women's nonemployment, and say over husbands' earnings (Appendix Table D1).

Having examined marriages formed before the reform, we next consider whether the reform also changes entry into new marriages, particularly among vulnerable women.

5.2 Marriage Entry

Table 5 examines whether the reform changed entry into first marriage. Panel A reports the overall estimate for ages 12–30 and separate estimates for three mutually exclusive age groups. Relative to non-Muslims, the quarterly probability of first marriage among Muslim women aged 12–30 declines by 0.182 percentage points, equivalent to 7.0 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean.

Panels B and C examine marriage entry separately among women without and with primary completion in each of the three age groups. Two considerations motivate this comparison. First, leaders of the women's-rights organizations we interviewed described women seeking assistance after triple talaq as frequently coming from economically and educationally disadvantaged households. Second, our results for pre-reform marriages are consistent with greater retention of vulnerable women within marriage. We therefore examine whether marriage entry also responds among women with limited schooling, distinguishing adolescents from older women.

Marriage entry declines most clearly among girls aged 12–17 without primary completion, with an estimated reduction of 18.2 percent relative to the pre-reform Muslim mean. Figure 1

shows this decline emerging around the reform and persisting afterward. We find no clear evidence of a change among women with primary completion.

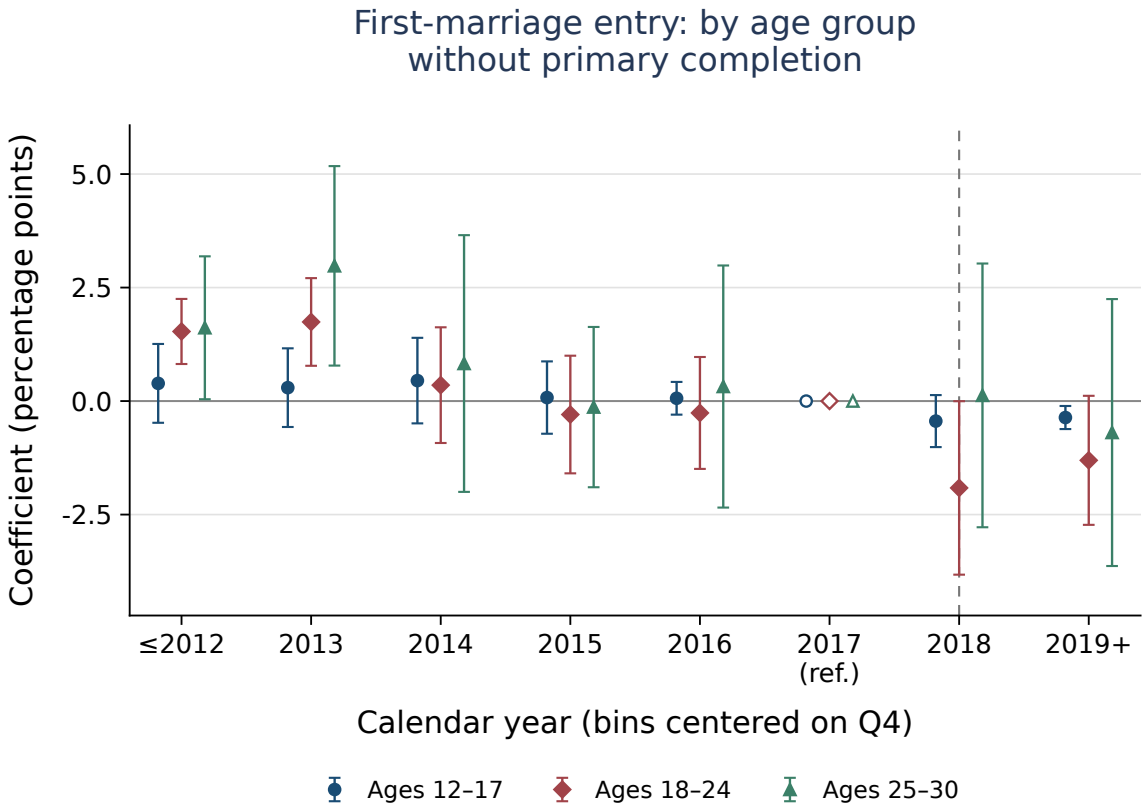


Figure 1: First-Marriage Entry by Age among Women without Primary Completion

Notes: Points show changes in the Muslim–non-Muslim quarterly first-marriage gap relative to each age group's bin centered on 2017 Q4. Blue circles, red diamonds, and green triangles denote ages 12–17, 18–24, and 25–30 at quarter start. Coefficients are in percentage points; bars show 95 percent confidence intervals based on state-clustered standard errors (35 states) and a $t(34)$ critical value. Small horizontal offsets separate the age groups within a bin; hollow markers show the normalized references. Year labels denote bins centered on Q4, formed by rounding the quarter difference from 2018 Q4 divided by four. The first and last points pool bins centered on 2012 Q4 and earlier and 2019 Q4 and later, respectively. The dashed line marks the 2018-centered reform bin, which straddles the reform; 2018 Q3 is omitted. Regressions use women's NFHS-5 survey weights and state × birth-year, religion, attained-age, and quarter-of-year fixed effects, matching Panel B of Table 5. Primary completion is measured at interview and applied to the retrospective histories.

These findings connect protection within existing marriages to entry into new marriages. Restrictions on husbands' unilateral exit may increase the survival of existing marriages involving vulnerable women while making prospective husbands less willing to enter such marriages. In our conceptual framework, holding potential matches fixed, reduced marriage

Table 5: First-Marriage Entry: Age and Primary Completion

Panel A. Age Groups

	(1) Ages 12–30	(2) Ages 12–17	(3) Ages 18–24	(4) Ages 25–30
Muslim × Post	-0.182*	-0.099	-0.188	0.053
	(0.096)	(0.075)	(0.198)	(0.478)
Non-Muslim (Pre-reform)	2.584	1.563	5.137	5.852
Non-Muslim (Post-reform)	2.371	0.640	3.831	5.599
Muslim (Pre-reform)	2.579	1.635	5.244	5.207
Person-quarter observations	21,605,491	14,988,512	5,847,819	769,128

Panel B. Without Primary Completion

	(1) Ages 12–17	(2) Ages 18–24	(3) Ages 25–30
Muslim × Post	-0.474**	-1.628***	-1.642
	(0.206)	(0.474)	(1.168)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.038	0.127	0.296
Non-Muslim (Pre-reform)	2.994	7.715	5.311
Non-Muslim (Post-reform)	2.020	8.063	5.046
Muslim (Pre-reform)	2.596	6.574	5.364
Person-quarter observations	3,793,535	1,111,215	151,181

Panel C. With Primary Completion

	(1) Ages 12–17	(2) Ages 18–24	(3) Ages 25–30
Muslim × Post	-0.109	-0.278	0.163
	(0.081)	(0.212)	(0.447)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.150	0.273	0.781
Non-Muslim (Pre-reform)	1.101	4.609	5.964
Non-Muslim (Post-reform)	0.577	3.669	5.625
Muslim (Pre-reform)	1.219	4.759	5.138
Person-quarter observations	11,191,707	4,735,438	617,763

Notes: Standard errors are clustered at the state level (35 clusters) and reported in parentheses. Significance stars use conventional state-clustered p-values: $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. Panels B and C also report wild-cluster bootstrap p-values with 520 replications, clustered by state.
The outcome equals one in the quarter of first cohabitation and zero in preceding quarters at risk. Each column uses the quarterly specification in Section 3 and women's survey weights from the post-reform survey. Age is measured at quarter start. Post begins in 2018 Q4; 2018 Q3 is omitted. Coefficients and standard errors are in percentage points; reference means are percentages of at-risk women entering first marriage in a quarter, calculated within each estimation sample using survey weights. Panel A reports the overall ages 12–30 estimate and the mutually exclusive age groups 12–17, 18–24, and 25–30.
Primary completion means at least five completed years of schooling, measured at interview and applied to the retrospective history. Panels B and C report the three age groups without and with primary completion, respectively, using the same specification. Observations are person-quarters. Wild-bootstrap p-values are reported for Panels B and C.

entry reflects greater reluctance among prospective husbands. The decline among young women without primary completion is consistent with this husband-side response.

5.3 New Marriages

The decline in marriage entry raises a further question: what happens in the marriages that do form under the new legal regime? Restrictions on husbands' unilateral exit may affect both who enters marriage and how spouses behave within marriage. We therefore examine dissolution, the characteristics of newly formed marriages, and women's experiences within them. Comparing these outcomes helps assess whether changes in marital experiences accompany changes in the composition of new marriages.

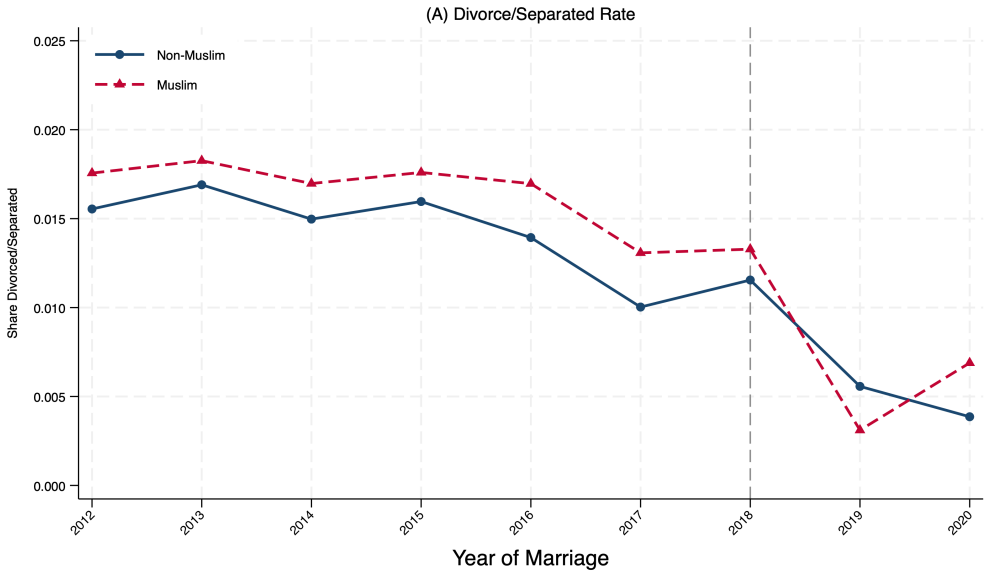
Here, *Post* equals one when first cohabitation began in September 2018 or later. The pre-reform-marriage analysis remains relevant because the earlier Muslim cohorts used as the comparison group were formed before the reform but include those that were observed after it. The estimates below compare Muslim marriages formed under the new legal regime with these earlier cohorts, relative to the corresponding cohort comparison among non-Muslims.

5.3.1 Dissolution

We first examine marital dissolution among newly formed marriages. Figure 2 plots the share of women who are divorced or separated by first-cohabitation cohort, separately for Muslims and non-Muslims. The two groups follow broadly similar patterns before the reform, and both have lower dissolution among more recent marriage cohorts. We examine whether dissolution declines further among Muslim women relative to this change among non-Muslims.

Table 6 shows that Muslim women whose marriages began after the reform are 0.4 percentage points less likely to be divorced, relative to the corresponding difference among non-Muslims. This represents a 44.2 percent decline relative to the pre-reform Muslim mean. The estimate for divorce or separation is also negative, at 0.3 percentage points, but is less

Figure 2: Divorce or Separation by Marriage Cohort



Notes: The figure plots the divorce-or-separation rate by first-cohabitation cohort, separately for Muslim and non-Muslim women. First cohabitation is used as the measure of marriage formation. The vertical line indicates the post-reform cutoff. The figure is descriptive.

precisely estimated.

Table 6: Dissolution among Newly Formed Marriages

	(1) Divorced	(2) Divorced or separated
Muslim × Post	-0.004^{***}	-0.003
	(0.001)	(0.002)
Wild-bootstrap p	< 0.002	0.158
Non-Muslim (Pre)	0.005	0.014
Non-Muslim (Post)	0.002	0.005
Muslim (Pre)	0.009	0.017
Observations	156,651	156,651

Notes: Standard errors are clustered at the state level (35 clusters) and reported in parentheses. Significance stars use conventional state-clustered p-values: $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. We also report wild-cluster bootstrap p-values using 520 replications, clustered by state; values below 0.002 are reported as < 0.002.
Ever-married women in NFHS-5 with first cohabitation from January 2012 onward. Post indicates first cohabitation in September 2018 or later. Outcomes and reference means are proportions.
Specifications include religion and state × first-cohabitation-year fixed effects. Regressions use NFHS survey weights.

The divorce event study in Figure 3 provides further evidence on the timing of this change.

The pre-reform estimates fluctuate around zero, with a larger but imprecisely estimated coefficient for the 2015-centered cohort bin. The coefficient becomes negative after the reform. This pattern is consistent with greater marital stability among Muslim marriages formed under the new legal regime. Whether this reflects changes in who marries or changes within marriage motivates our examination of the characteristics of newly formed marriages.

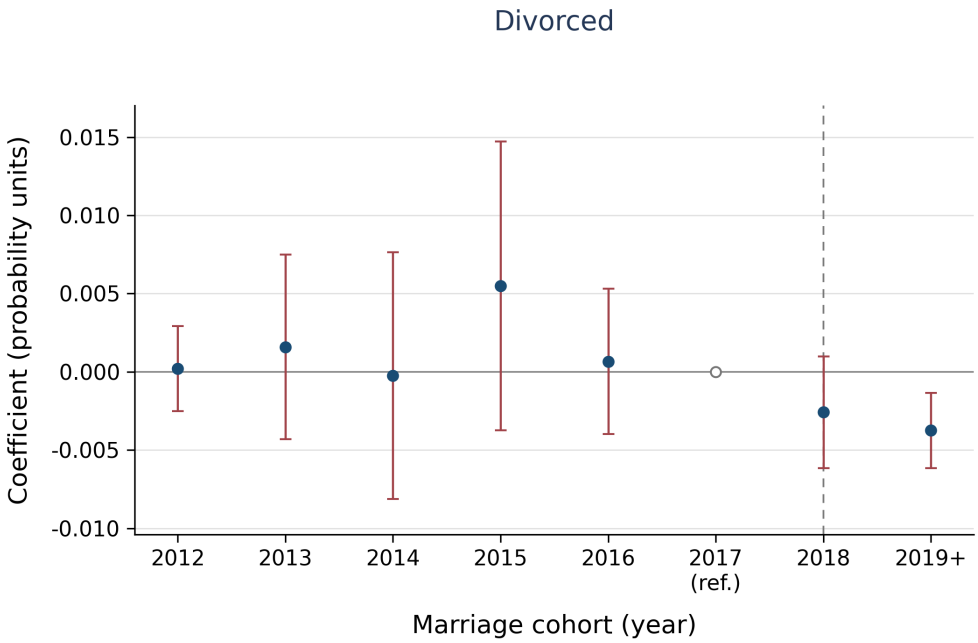


Figure 3: Divorce Event Study among Newly Formed Marriages

Notes: Year labels denote cohort bins centered on September anniversaries, formed by rounding the month difference from September 2018 divided by twelve. The 2017 bin is the reference, and 2019+ pools later bins. The 2018 bin straddles the reform; 2012 is a single bin. The dashed line marks September 2018, and the hollow point marks the normalized reference. The figure uses NFHS-5 and women's survey weights. The specification includes religion, state-by-first-cohabitation-year, and rounded-event-bin fixed effects. Points are Muslim-by-event-bin coefficients in probability units, with 95 percent confidence intervals based on standard errors clustered by state.

5.3.2 Composition and Match Characteristics

The decline in divorce raises the question of whether marriages formed after the reform differ from earlier marriages. Table 7 examines changes in age at first cohabitation, spousal age gaps, women's schooling, and employment. Unlike the shifts toward younger brides and

larger spousal age gaps among surviving pre-reform marriages, Panel A provides no clear evidence of corresponding changes among newly formed marriages.

Panel B likewise shows limited evidence of a systematic change in women's schooling and employment. Secondary completion declines by 2.7 percentage points, approximately 10.6 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean, although this estimate is less precisely supported under bootstrap inference and adjustment for multiple testing. The remaining estimates are imprecise.

Taken together, the decline in divorce occurs without a clear, broad shift in these observed characteristics.

5.3.3 Women's Experiences

Panel A of Table 8 shows a 4.2 percentage-point increase in participation in at least one household decision, approximately 5 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean. The individual decision outcomes are imprecisely estimated. Women in surviving pre-reform marriages report less say over their husbands' earnings after the reform. Because these marriages enter the comparison group, a decline in their decision-making could make post-reform marriages appear relatively better even without an improvement in newly formed marriages. We therefore repeat the analysis using only pre-reform marriages observed before the reform as the comparison group. The estimated increase in participation in at least one decision remains similar, at 4.3 percentage points (Appendix Table D16).

Panel B provides suggestive evidence of a decline in emotional IPV. The estimated reduction is 4.9 percentage points, approximately 46 percent of the pre-reform Muslim mean, although statistical support weakens under wild-cluster bootstrap inference. The physical- and sexual-IPV estimates are imprecise and differ in sign.

The emotional-IPV event study in Figure 4 also suggests a decline after the reform.

Table 7: Characteristics of Newly Formed Marriages

Panel A. Age and Match Characteristics

	(1) Age at first cohabitation	(2) Age gap ≥ 5 years	(3) Age gap ≥ 10 years
Muslim × Post	0.153	0.006	0.009
	(0.126)	(0.039)	(0.013)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.342	0.915	0.546
Holm-adjusted p	0.693	0.960	0.960
Non-Muslim (Pre)	20.298	0.423	0.094
Non-Muslim (Post)	21.262	0.374	0.070
Muslim (Pre)	19.846	0.463	0.089
Observations	233,242	36,560	36,560

Panel B. Women's Schooling and Employment

	(1) Years of schooling	(2) Primary completed	(3) Secondary completed	(4) Woman not working
Muslim × Post	−0.196	0.008	−0.027*	−0.023
	(0.120)	(0.006)	(0.013)	(0.019)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.327	0.150	0.204	0.215
Holm-adjusted p	0.337	0.432	0.205	0.432
Non-Muslim (Pre)	9.489	0.857	0.391	0.843
Non-Muslim (Post)	10.600	0.918	0.502	0.876
Muslim (Pre)	7.937	0.785	0.254	0.917
Observations	233,004	233,004	227,582	37,102

Notes: Standard errors are clustered at the state level (35 clusters) and reported in parentheses. Significance stars use conventional state-clustered p-values: $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. We also report wild-cluster bootstrap p-values using 520 replications, clustered by state. Holm-adjusted p-values apply the step-down correction to conventional state-clustered p-values separately across the three outcomes in Panel A and the four outcomes in Panel B.
First-cohabitation cohorts from January 2012 onward in NFHS-4 and NFHS-5. Post indicates first cohabitation in September 2018 or later. Specifications include religion, state × first-cohabitation-year, and survey-wave fixed effects.
Age at first cohabitation and schooling are in years; binary outcomes and reference means are proportions. Age and age gaps describe marriage formation. Schooling and employment are measured at interview. Secondary completion is restricted to women aged 18 or older. Regressions use the appropriate NFHS survey weights; samples vary by outcome and module.

Table 8: Women's Experiences in Newly Formed Marriages

Panel A. Household Decision-Making

	(1) Healthcare	(2) Large purchases	(3) Visits to relatives	(4) Husband's earnings	(5) Any decision
Muslim × Post	0.012	−0.005	0.015	−0.001	0.042*
	(0.021)	(0.040)	(0.022)	(0.050)	(0.022)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.546	0.935	0.569	0.985	0.065
Holm-adjusted p	1.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	–
Non-Muslim (Pre)	0.742	0.706	0.734	0.709	0.856
Non-Muslim (Post)	0.719	0.683	0.724	0.694	0.845
Muslim (Pre)	0.726	0.686	0.702	0.653	0.825
Observations	35,329	35,329	35,329	35,329	35,329

Panel B. Intimate Partner Violence

	(1) Emotional IPV	(2) Physical IPV	(3) Sexual IPV
Muslim × Post	−0.049**	−0.016	0.026
	(0.020)	(0.042)	(0.016)
Wild-bootstrap p	0.158	0.785	0.154
Holm-adjusted p	0.058	0.711	0.225
Non-Muslim (Pre)	0.107	0.205	0.048
Non-Muslim (Post)	0.065	0.114	0.025
Muslim (Pre)	0.107	0.206	0.056
Observations	25,702	25,702	25,702

Notes: Standard errors are clustered at the state level (35 clusters) and reported in parentheses. Significance stars use conventional state-clustered p-values: $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$. We also report wild-cluster bootstrap p-values using 520 replications, clustered by state; values below 0.002 are reported as < 0.002. Holm-adjusted p-values apply the step-down correction to conventional state-clustered p-values separately across the four individual decision outcomes in Panel A and the three IPV outcomes in Panel B. Any Decision is a summary outcome reported separately and excluded from the multiple-testing family; its Holm entry is a dash.
First-cohabitation cohorts from January 2012 onward in NFHS-4 and NFHS-5. Post indicates first cohabitation in September 2018 or later. Specifications include religion, state × first-cohabitation-year, and survey-wave fixed effects. Both panels additionally include years-since-marriage fixed effects.
Outcomes and reference means are proportions. Decision-making records participation alone or jointly; Any Decision indicates participation in at least one of the four decisions. IPV measures report ever experiencing the indicated form of violence. Regressions use the appropriate NFHS survey/module weights, including domestic-violence weights for the IPV outcomes. Samples vary by outcome and module.

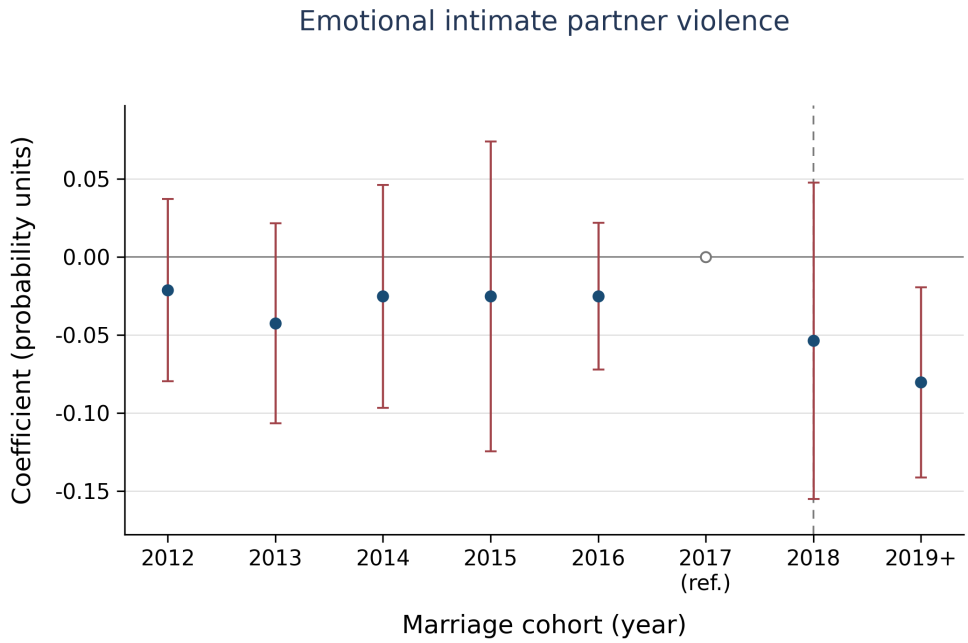


Figure 4: Emotional Intimate Partner Violence Event Study among Newly Formed Marriages

Notes: Year labels denote cohort bins centered on September anniversaries, formed by rounding the month difference from September 2018 divided by twelve. The 2017 bin is the reference, and 2019+ pools later bins. The 2018 bin straddles the reform; 2012 is a single bin. The dashed line marks September 2018, and the hollow point marks the normalized reference. The figure uses the relevant domestic-violence sample in both surveys and domestic-violence weights. The specification includes religion, state-by-first-cohabitation-year, survey-round, rounded-event-bin, and years-since-marriage fixed effects. Points are Muslim-by-event-bin coefficients in probability units, with 95 percent confidence intervals based on standard errors clustered by state.

Lower divorce and the suggestive improvements in women's decision-making and emotional IPV are consistent with greater commitment within newly formed marriages, although changes in who marries may also contribute. Restrictions on husbands' instantaneous exit may encourage spouses to invest more in maintaining their relationships.

6 Robustness

This section summarizes a range of robustness checks, all reported in the appendix. We assess the sensitivity of our findings to the comparison group, alternative fixed effects and marriage-cohort windows, and placebo reform timing. We also report event-study estimates for additional outcomes and examine statistical inference using wild-cluster bootstrap and multiple-testing adjustments.

A potential concern is that the marriage outcomes reflect a broader deterioration in Muslims' economic circumstances around the reform. We examine this possibility using employment and earnings among men aged 25–54 in the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS). Appendix Table D19 compares changes among Muslim men with changes among non-Muslim men around the reform. We find no evidence of a broad relative deterioration in Muslim men's employment or earnings around the reform.

For outcomes among new marriages, we repeat the analysis using only earlier marriages observed before the reform as the comparison group (Appendix Tables D14–D18). Our analysis of pre-reform marriages suggests that the reform may affect both which marriages remain intact and women's experiences within them. Restricting the comparison group in this way removes earlier marriages that may already have been affected by the reform. The estimated increase in women's participation in any household decision and decline in emotional intimate partner violence remain similar in magnitude to the baseline estimates. This check is unavailable for dissolution because the pre-reform survey does not report first-cohabitation timing for divorced women.

We also examine sensitivity to alternative fixed effects in the analyses of pre-reform marriages and outcomes among new marriages. We replace marriage-year with birth-year fixed effects, allow cohort effects to vary by state, and estimate specifications with district fixed effects (Appendix Tables D3–D8 and D9–D13). Among surviving pre-reform marriages, the estimates continue to indicate younger ages at first cohabitation, a higher probability of having a husband at least five years older, and reduced say over husbands' earnings. Among new marriages, the estimated decline in divorce changes little across specifications. The increase in participation in any household decision and decline in emotional intimate partner violence also retain their direction, although their precision varies.

We also restrict the analysis of surviving pre-reform marriages to women whose first cohabitation began between January 2012 and December 2015. This reduces reliance on later marriage cohorts that the pre-reform survey could not fully observe. The estimates continue to indicate younger ages at first cohabitation, a higher probability of having a husband at least five years older, greater nonemployment, and reduced say over husbands' earnings (Appendix Table D1). Excluding observed marriages beginning after 2015 from the dissolution analysis also leaves the estimated decline in formal divorce largely unchanged (Appendix Table D2).

Appendix Section C reports event-study estimates for additional outcomes among newly formed marriages, including marriage characteristics, women's decision-making, and intimate partner violence. For participation in any household decision, pre-reform coefficients are positive but imprecisely estimated. The coefficients are larger in the bin after the reform. This pattern is consistent with improved decision-making, although the positive pre-reform coefficients warrant retaining our suggestive interpretation.

We next conduct a placebo exercise for outcomes among newly formed marriages. Following Kuka et al. (2020), we randomly assign marriage months to placebo treatment, preserving the observed number of post-reform months. We repeat this procedure 1,000 times, keeping the sample, controls, and fixed effects unchanged, and compare the resulting estimates

with our baseline estimates. The estimated decline in divorce, decline in emotional intimate partner violence, and increase in participation in any household decision lie in the tails of their respective placebo distributions (Appendix Figures E1–E5). These results indicate that similarly large estimates are uncommon under these placebo assignments.

Overall, the findings remain broadly consistent across the robustness checks, supporting the main results.

7 Conclusion

This paper uses India's triple talaq reform to examine how restricting husbands' ability to end a marriage instantaneously and unilaterally, while leaving women's access to divorce unchanged, affects existing marriages, entry into first marriage, and outcomes among newly formed marriages.

Among marriages formed before the reform, we estimate lower formal divorce and increases in the shares of surviving marriages involving women who married at ages 12–17 and couples with husbands at least five years older. Examining marriage entry across age and schooling groups, the clearest evidence of a decline occurs among girls aged 12–17 without primary completion. Together, these patterns suggest that greater protection against husbands' exit may increase the survival of existing marriages involving vulnerable women while making prospective husbands less willing to enter such marriages.

Among newly formed marriages, we find lower divorce and suggestive evidence of increased participation in household decisions and reduced emotional intimate partner violence. These findings are consistent with greater commitment within marriage.

The findings highlight the importance of whose exit option changes. Greater protection within marriage can have different consequences for women who are already married and those considering marriage. Evaluating divorce reform therefore requires examining who remains married, who enters marriage, and women's experiences within the marriages that

form.

Appendix

A. Data and Descriptive Evidence . . . 40
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A Data and Descriptive Evidence

A.1 Sample Composition across Survey Rounds

Table A1: Sample Composition across NFHS Survey Rounds

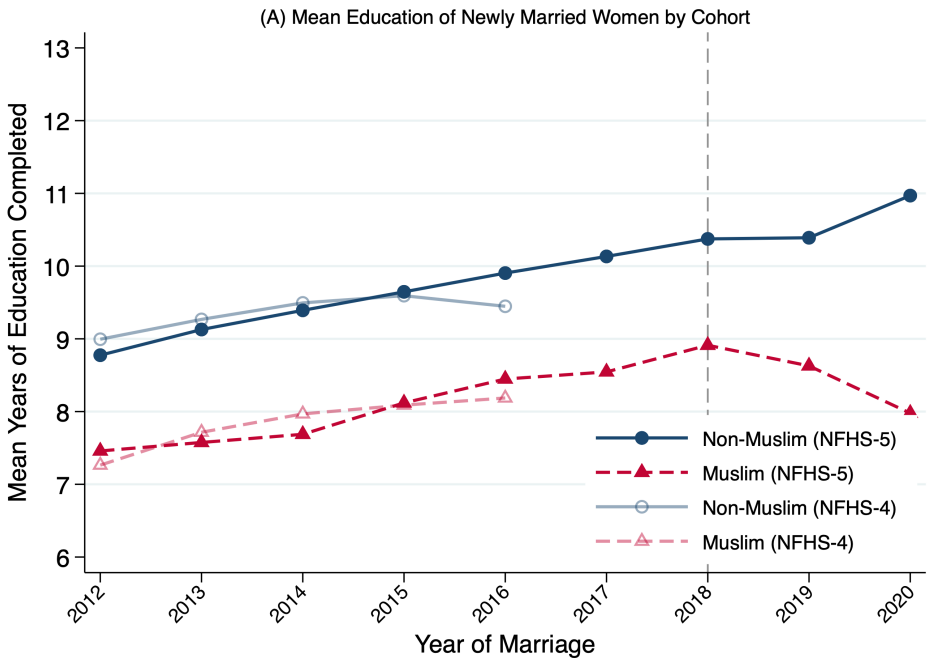
	(1) Age	(2) Muslim
Post_w	0.525***	-0.006
	(0.082)	(0.005)
Muslim	-1.313***	
	(0.128)	
Post_w × Muslim	-0.009	
	(0.070)	
Observations	1,423,801	1,423,801
State FE	Yes	Yes

Standard errors clustered at the state level.
Column 1 tests whether the Muslim–non-Muslim age gap changes across NFHS rounds.
Column 2 tests whether the weighted Muslim share changes across NFHS rounds within states.

A.2 Descriptive Schooling Trends

Figure A1 plots mean years of education among newly married women by first-cohabitation cohort, separately for Muslim and non-Muslim women.

Figure A1: Mean Years of Education among Newly Married Women by Marriage Cohort



Notes: The figure plots average years of education among newly married women by first-cohabitation cohort, separately for Muslim and non-Muslim women. First cohabitation is used as the measure of marriage formation. The vertical line indicates the post-reform cutoff. The figure is descriptive.

B Additional Results

B.1 Spouse Characteristics

Table B1: Spouse Characteristics in Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages

	(1) Husband high-skilled	(2) Husband: primary	(3) Husband: secondary
Muslim × Post	−0.002	−0.008	0.009
	(0.026)	(0.013)	(0.021)
Non-Muslim (NFHS-4)	0.176	0.890	0.401
Non-Muslim (NFHS-5)	0.154	0.883	0.396
Muslim (NFHS-4)	0.152	0.781	0.248
Observations	30,448	32,421	32,421

Notes: State-clustered standard errors are in parentheses. $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.
Currently married women whose first cohabitation began in January 2012–August 2018, observed in NFHS-4 or NFHS-5. Post indicates observation in NFHS-5. Specifications include religion, first-cohabitation-year, and state × survey-wave fixed effects.
Outcomes and reference means are proportions. Spouse schooling and occupation are measured at interview. Husband high-skilled is defined among working husbands. Regressions use the appropriate NFHS survey weights; samples vary by outcome.

Table B2: Spouse Characteristics in Newly Formed Marriages

	(1) Husband high-skilled	(2) Husband: primary	(3) Husband: secondary
Muslim × Post	−0.060**	0.017	−0.074
	(0.029)	(0.033)	(0.052)
Non-Muslim (Pre)	0.162	0.883	0.396
Non-Muslim (Post)	0.182	0.925	0.501
Muslim (Pre)	0.136	0.760	0.237
Observations	34,641	36,966	36,966

Notes: State-clustered standard errors are in parentheses. $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.
First-cohabitation cohorts from January 2012 onward in NFHS-4 and NFHS-5. Post indicates first cohabitation in September 2018 or later. Specifications include religion, state × first-cohabitation-year, and survey-wave fixed effects.
Outcomes and reference means are proportions. Spouse schooling and occupation are measured at interview. Husband high-skilled is defined among working husbands. Regressions use the appropriate NFHS survey weights; samples vary by outcome.

B.2 Attitudes toward Wife-Beating and Husbands' Controlling Behavior

Table B3: Wife-Beating Attitudes and Husbands' Controlling Behavior

Panel A. Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages

	(1) Wife beating justified	(2) Husband controlling
Muslim × Post	0.001	0.018
	(0.025)	(0.032)
Non-Muslim (NFHS-4)	0.407	0.490
Non-Muslim (NFHS-5)	0.358	0.452
Muslim (NFHS-4)	0.450	0.475
Observations	32,498	22,891

Panel B. Newly Formed Marriages

	(1) Wife beating justified	(2) Husband controlling
Muslim × Post	−0.077	−0.122
	(0.048)	(0.092)
Non-Muslim (Pre)	0.378	0.470
Non-Muslim (Post)	0.348	0.473
Muslim (Pre)	0.412	0.475
Observations	37,068	25,687

Notes: State-clustered standard errors are in parentheses. $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.
Outcomes and reference means are proportions. Panel A: Currently married women whose first cohabitation began in January 2012–August 2018, observed in NFHS-4 or NFHS-5. Post indicates observation in NFHS-5. Specifications include religion, first-cohabitation-year, and state × survey-wave fixed effects. Panel B: First-cohabitation cohorts from January 2012 onward in NFHS-4 and NFHS-5. Post indicates first cohabitation in September 2018 or later. Specifications include religion, state × first-cohabitation-year, and survey-wave fixed effects.
Both panels additionally include years-since-marriage fixed effects. Wife-beating attitudes use women's survey weights; controlling behavior uses domestic-violence weights. Samples vary by module and outcome.

B.3 Full-Sample Marital-Status Decomposition

Table B4 adds never-married women and decomposes the mutually exclusive current-status categories in the unrestricted full sample. The binary outcomes are multiplied by 100 before estimation, so all coefficients and standard errors are reported in percentage points. The

divorce-or-separation coefficient equals the sum of the separate divorce and separation coefficients; the small positive separation estimate partly offsets the negative divorce estimate, while adding sampling variation.

Table B4: Marital-Status Outcomes in the Full Sample

	Never Married	Currently Married	Widowed	Divorced	Separated	Divorced/Separated
Muslim × NFHS5$_w$	-0.902***	1.193***	-0.239*	-0.068**	0.015	-0.052
	(0.317)	(0.330)	(0.140)	(0.032)	(0.058)	(0.057)
Non-Muslim (NFHS-4), percent	22.127	73.614	3.202	0.303	0.755	1.058
Non-Muslim (NFHS-5), percent	23.386	72.260	3.262	0.309	0.783	1.092
Muslim (NFHS-4), percent	26.495	69.787	2.431	0.578	0.709	1.288
Observations	1423801	1423801	1423801	1423801	1423801	1423801

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Notes: The binary outcomes are multiplied by 100 before estimation, so coefficients and standard errors are reported in percentage points. Each column reports the coefficient on $Muslim_i \times Post_w$, where $Post_w$ indicates observation in NFHS-5 (2019–21). Never married, currently married, widowed, divorced, and separated are mutually exclusive categories; currently married includes women who report being married or living with a partner, and divorced or separated combines the latter two categories. All specifications use the unrestricted full sample and include religion, state, survey-wave, state × survey-wave, and age fixed effects. Regressions use NFHS survey weights, with standard errors clustered at the state level.

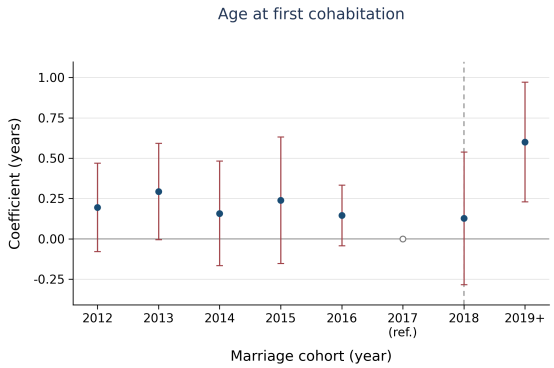
C Additional Event Studies

These figures report additional event-study estimates for newly formed marriages using the baseline comparison group, which includes pre-reform marriage cohorts observed in either survey. Year labels denote cohort bins centered on September anniversaries, formed by rounding the month difference from September 2018 divided by twelve. The 2017 bin is the reference, and 2019+ pools later bins. The 2018 bin straddles the reform; 2012 is a single bin. The dashed line marks September 2018, and the hollow point marks the normalized reference.

Specifications include religion, state-by-first-cohabitation-year, and rounded-event-bin fixed effects, together with survey-round fixed effects when both surveys are used. Decision-making, intimate partner violence, and related outcomes additionally include years-since-marriage fixed effects. Divorce or separation uses NFHS-5 only. Regressions use the appropriate NFHS survey weights; 95 percent confidence intervals use standard errors clustered by state. Divorce and emotional-IPV event studies appear in the main text. Estimates using only pre-reform NFHS-4 observations as the comparison group are reported in Section D.4.



(a) Divorced or separated



(b) Age at first cohabitation

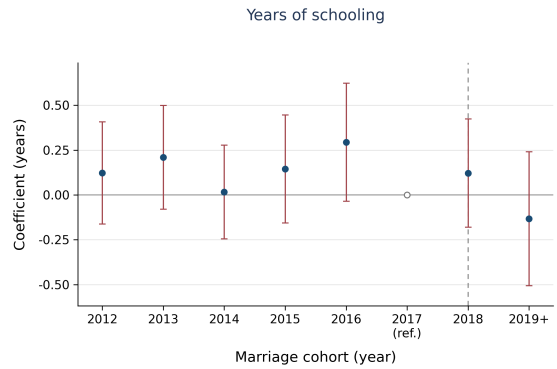


(c) Husband age gap ≥ 5 years

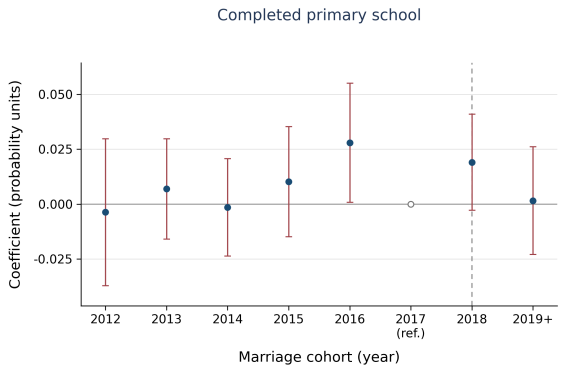


(d) Husband age gap ≥ 10 years

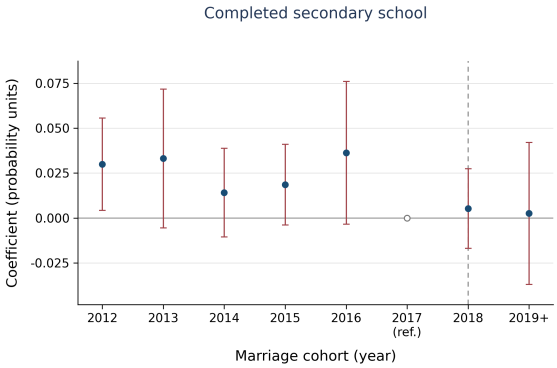
Figure C1: Event Studies for Newly Formed Marriages: Dissolution and Marriage Characteristics



(a) Years of education



(b) Primary completed

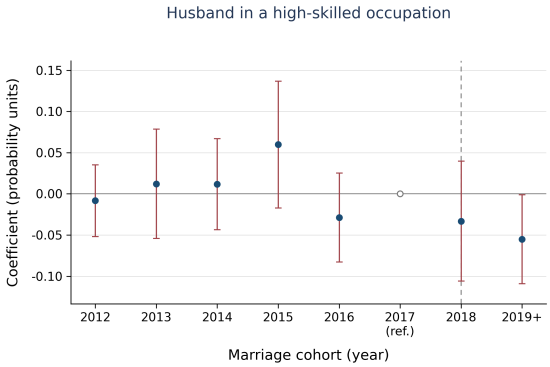


(c) Secondary completed

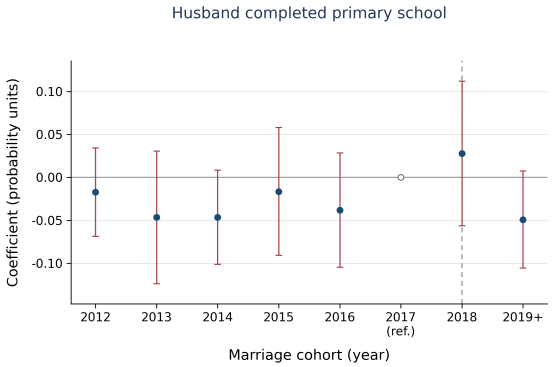


(d) Not working

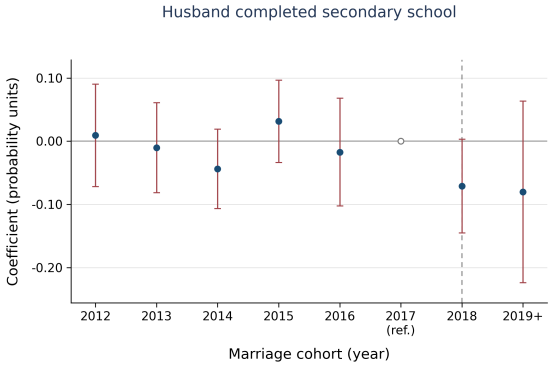
Figure C2: Event Studies for Newly Formed Marriages: Women's Characteristics



(a) Husband high-skilled

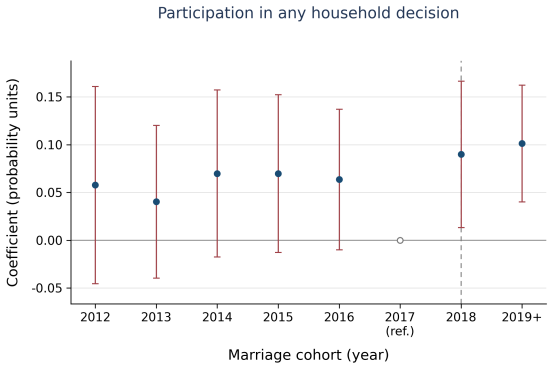


(b) Spouse primary completed

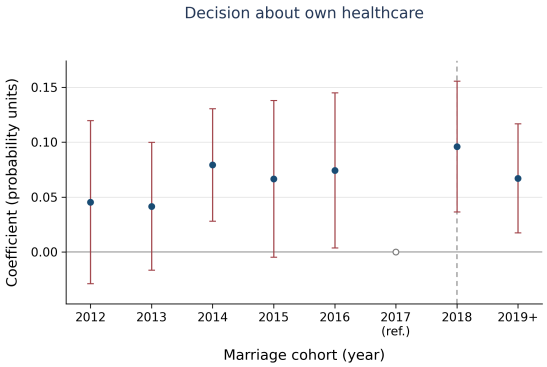


(c) Spouse secondary completed

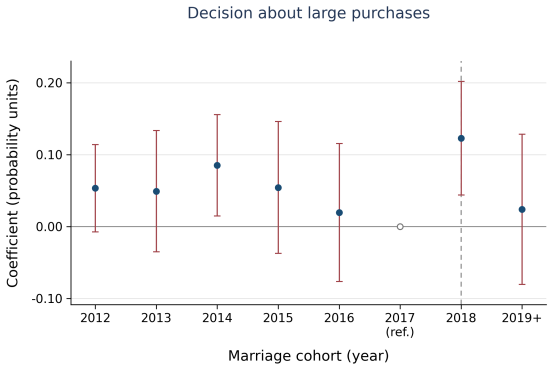
Figure C3: Event Studies for Newly Formed Marriages: Spouse Characteristics



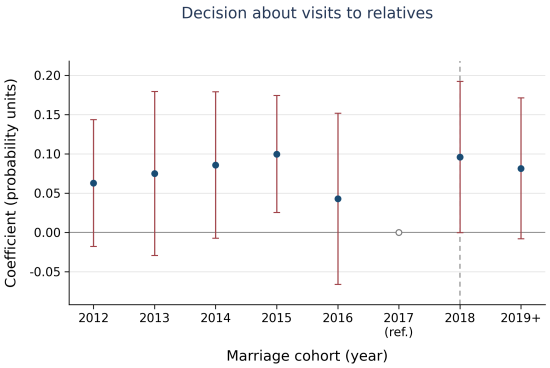
(a) Any decision



(b) Healthcare



(c) Large purchases



(d) Relatives

Figure C4: Event Studies for Newly Formed Marriages: Household Decision-Making

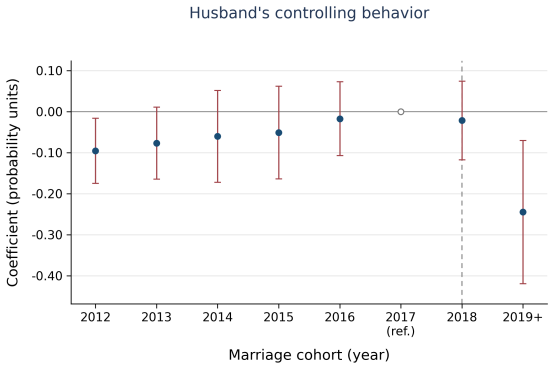


(a) Husband's money

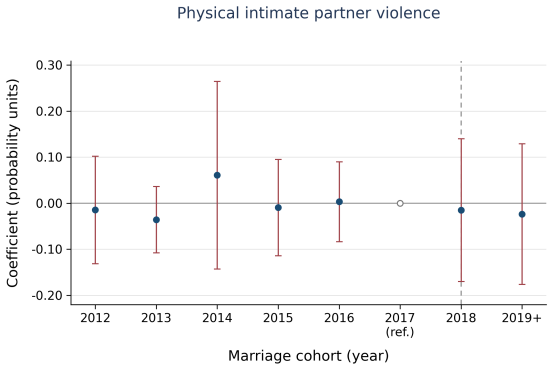
Figure C5: Event Study for Newly Formed Marriages: Say over Husband's Earnings



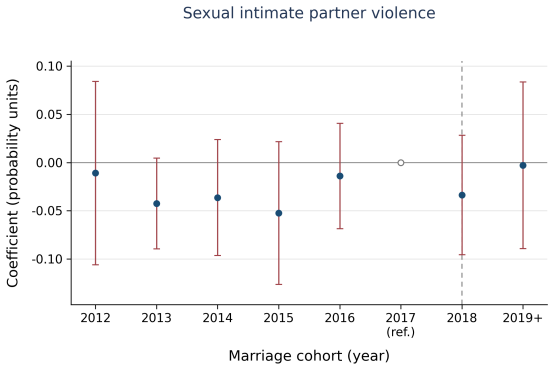
(a) Wife-beating beliefs



(b) Husband controlling



(c) Physical IPV



(d) Sexual IPV

Figure C6: Event Studies for Newly Formed Marriages: Violence, Attitudes, and Controlling Behavior

D Robustness Checks

D.1 Pre-Reform Marriage-Cohort Restrictions

Table D1 compares the baseline pre-reform married-stock estimates with estimates restricted to women whose first cohabitation occurred from January 2012 through December 2015. All women in these regressions are currently married when surveyed. The specifications, outcome-specific sample rules, survey weights, and state-clustered standard errors match the main results. Intimate-partner-violence and decision-making outcomes additionally include years-since-marriage fixed effects. The restriction removes the 2016–2018 marriage cohorts, which were observed unevenly across NFHS rounds. NFHS-4 fieldwork took place during 2015–16, so its coverage of marriages formed in 2015 is still incomplete.

Table D2 applies a related restriction to the divorce outcomes. It excludes marriages beginning after December 2015 wherever the first-cohabitation year is observed. NFHS-4 does not report that year for formerly married women, so these respondents remain in the sample with their existing unknown-marriage-year fixed-effect category. This is an exclusion of observed post-2015 marriages, rather than a fully symmetric 2012–2015 cohort restriction.

Table D1: Pre-Reform Married Stock: Restricting Marriage Cohorts to 2012–2015

Outcome	Baseline	2012–2015	Baseline N	Restricted N
Marriage characteristics				
Age at first cohabitation	-0.300 (0.096)	-0.281 (0.091)	202,666	147,080
Husband at least 5 years older	0.057 (0.016)	0.041 (0.019)	32,509	23,975
Husband at least 10 years older	0.019 (0.011)	0.018 (0.014)	32,509	23,975
Intimate partner violence and related outcomes				
Wife beating justified	0.001 (0.025)	0.002 (0.025)	32,498	23,959
Husband controlling	0.018 (0.032)	-0.035 (0.051)	22,891	17,064
Emotional IPV	-0.011 (0.015)	-0.027 (0.015)	22,902	17,073
Physical IPV	0.001 (0.016)	-0.002 (0.017)	22,902	17,073
Sexual IPV	0.022 (0.021)	0.016 (0.017)	22,902	17,073
Women's characteristics				
Years of education	0.005 (0.069)	-0.001 (0.074)	202,443	146,880
Primary completed	0.010 (0.005)	0.006 (0.005)	202,443	146,880
Secondary completed	-0.014 (0.008)	-0.011 (0.009)	198,419	144,020
Woman not working	0.053 (0.016)	0.056 (0.016)	32,528	23,986
Spouse characteristics				
Husband high-skilled	-0.002 (0.026)	0.019 (0.024)	30,448	22,433
Spouse primary education	-0.008 (0.013)	-0.020 (0.014)	32,421	23,915
Spouse secondary education	0.009 (0.021)	0.037 (0.023)	32,421	23,915
Decision-making				
Healthcare	-0.019 (0.018)	-0.022 (0.022)	31,441	23,162
Large purchases	-0.024 (0.018)	-0.019 (0.025)	31,441	23,162
Visits to relatives	-0.032 (0.022)	-0.019 (0.029)	31,441	23,162
Husband's earnings	-0.052 (0.017)	-0.049 (0.023)	31,441	23,162
Any decision	-0.003 (0.015)	0.009 (0.019)	31,441	23,162

Notes: Each cell reports the coefficient on $Muslim_i \times Post_w$, with state-clustered standard errors in parentheses. $Post_w$ indicates observation in NFHS-5. The baseline sample includes currently married women whose first cohabitation occurred from January 2012 through August 2018; the restricted sample ends in December 2015. Binary outcomes are reported in their original zero-to-one units. Specifications include religion, marriage-year, state, and state × survey-wave fixed effects. IPV and decision-making outcomes also include years-since-marriage fixed effects. The secondary-completion outcome includes women age 18 or older; decision outcomes require an observed any-decision response. Regressions use women's survey weights, except husband-control and IPV outcomes, which use domestic-violence weights. The three IPV severity-count measures are excluded from this table.

Table D2: Pre-Reform Divorce: Excluding Observed Post-2015 Marriages

Outcome	Baseline	Excluding observed post-2015	Baseline N	Restricted N
Divorced	-0.082 (0.042)	-0.084 (0.048)	1,043,170	986,567
Divorced or separated	-0.060 (0.080)	-0.055 (0.083)	1,043,170	986,567

Notes: Each cell reports the coefficient on $Muslim_i \times Post_w$, with state-clustered standard errors in parentheses. Divorce indicators are multiplied by 100, so estimates are in percentage points. The baseline includes all ever-married NFHS-4 women and ever-married NFHS-5 women whose first cohabitation preceded September 2018. The restricted sample excludes observed first marriages beginning in 2016 or later in either wave, retaining NFHS-4 formerly married women whose marriage year is unavailable. Earlier marriages remain in both samples. Specifications include religion, marriage-year, state, and state $\times$ survey-wave fixed effects and use women's survey weights.

D.2 Alternative Fixed Effects: Pre-Reform Marriages

These tables report the baseline and alternative-fixed-effects specifications for the survey-round design of the pre-reform married stock. The divorce outcomes use the broader ever-married sample described in the main text: all ever-married women in NFHS-4 and ever-married women whose first cohabitation began before September 2018 in NFHS-5. The other outcomes restrict the sample to currently married women whose first cohabitation began between January 2012 and August 2018. Each column reports the coefficient on $Muslim_i \times Post_w$, where $Post_w$ indicates observation in NFHS-5. Column (2) is the baseline specification reported in the main text; it includes religion, marriage-year, state, survey-wave, and state × survey-wave fixed effects. Column (1) omits the state × survey-wave interaction; column (3) replaces state with district fixed effects where applicable; column (4) replaces marriage-year with birth-year fixed effects; and column (5) adds state × birth-year fixed effects. The IPV and decision-making tables omit the district specification, so their columns (3) and (4) are the birth-year and state × birth-year variants. These two outcome families also include years-since-marriage fixed effects throughout. All regressions use the appropriate NFHS survey weights, with standard errors clustered at the state level.

Table D3: Pre-Reform Marriages: Divorce—Baseline and Alternative Fixed Effects

	Divorced (pp)					Divorced or Separated (pp)				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Muslim × Post	-0.128**	-0.082*	-0.132**	-0.095*	-0.089	-0.200**	-0.060	-0.211**	-0.101	-0.090
	(0.056)	(0.042)	(0.055)	(0.056)	(0.058)	(0.091)	(0.080)	(0.091)	(0.090)	(0.096)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Survey-Round FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
State × Survey-Round FE	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes
District FE	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No
Years-Since-Marriage FE	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	No
Observations	1,043,170	1,043,170	1,043,170	1,043,170	1,043,149	1,043,170	1,043,170	1,043,170	1,043,170	1,043,149

Table D4: Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages: Age at First Marriage and Age Gaps—Baseline and Alternative Fixed Effects

	Age at First Cohabitation					Husband Older than 5 Years					Husband Older than 10 Years				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Muslim × NFHS5$_w$	-0.269**	-0.300***	-0.200**	-0.139***	-0.125***	0.045**	0.057***		0.040**	0.045**	0.014	0.019*		0.013	0.016
	(0.110)	(0.096)	(0.089)	(0.035)	(0.040)	(0.017)	(0.016)		(0.017)	(0.018)	(0.011)	(0.011)		(0.012)	(0.013)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
Survey-Round FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
State × Survey-Round FE	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes
District FE	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	–	No	No
Observations	202,666	202,666	202,666	202,665	202,541	32,509	32,509	.	32,506	32,366	32,509	32,509	.	32,506	32,366

Table D5: Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages: Intimate Partner Violence and Related Outcomes—Baseline and Alternative Fixed Effects

	Wife Beating Justified				Controlling Behavior				Emotional IPV				Physical IPV				Sexual IPV			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Muslim × NFHS5$_w$	-0.011	0.001	-0.007	-0.008	0.016	0.018	0.015	0.010	-0.005	-0.011	-0.007	-0.003	0.010	0.001	0.009	0.009	0.020	0.022	0.023	0.024
	(0.024)	(0.025)	(0.021)	(0.019)	(0.035)	(0.032)	(0.034)	(0.036)	(0.016)	(0.015)	(0.015)	(0.014)	(0.016)	(0.016)	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.019)	(0.021)	(0.020)	(0.019)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Survey-Round FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
State × Survey-Round FE	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes
Years-Since-Marriage FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	32,498	32,498	32,495	32,358	22,891	22,891	22,888	22,733	22,902	22,902	22,899	22,744	22,902	22,902	22,899	22,744	22,902	22,902	22,899	22,744

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table D6: Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages: Women's Decision-Making—Baseline and Alternative Fixed Effects

	Own Health Care				Large Purchases				Visits to Relatives				Husband's Money				Any Decision			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Muslim × NFHS5$_w$	-0.017	-0.019	-0.022	-0.027	-0.020	-0.024	-0.028	-0.027	-0.035	-0.032	-0.044	-0.043*	-0.050**	-0.052***	-0.052***	-0.052***	-0.005	-0.003	-0.011	-0.013
	(0.020)	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.020)	(0.018)	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.028)	(0.022)	(0.026)	(0.025)	(0.021)	(0.017)	(0.018)	(0.019)	(0.016)	(0.015)	(0.015)	(0.016)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Survey-Round FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
State × Survey-Round FE	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes
Years-Since-Marriage FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	31,441	31,441	31,438	31,299	31,441	31,441	31,438	31,299	31,441	31,441	31,438	31,299	31,441	31,441	31,438	31,299	31,441	31,441	31,438	31,299

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table D7: Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages: Education and Spouse Education—Baseline and Alternative Fixed Effects

	Husband More Educated					Years of Education					Completed Primary					Spouse: Primary					Spouse: Secondary					Completed Secondary				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Muslim × NFHS5$_w$	0.027	0.022		0.025	0.025	0.024	0.005	0.073	0.046	0.025	0.011**	0.010**	0.011**	0.010*	0.007	-0.005	-0.008		-0.004	-0.004	0.011	0.009		0.019	0.021	-0.010	-0.014*	-0.005	-0.007	-0.005
	(0.026)	(0.030)		(0.025)	(0.026)	(0.066)	(0.069)	(0.066)	(0.084)	(0.080)	(0.005)	(0.005)	(0.005)	(0.005)	(0.005)	(0.014)	(0.013)		(0.015)	(0.013)	(0.017)	(0.021)		(0.016)	(0.016)	(0.007)	(0.008)	(0.007)	(0.010)	(0.011)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Survey-Round FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
State × Survey-Round FE	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes
District FE	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No
Observations	32,384	32,384	.	32,381	32,242	202,443	202,443	202,443	202,442	202,318	202,443	202,443	202,443	202,442	202,318	32,421	32,421	.	32,418	32,279	32,421	32,421	.	32,418	32,279	198,419	198,419	198,419	198,418	198,309

Table D8: Surviving Pre-Reform Marriages: Employment and Occupation—Baseline and Alternative Fixed Effects

	Not Working					Husband High-Skilled				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Muslim × NFHS5$_w$	0.052***	0.053***		0.051***	0.051***	0.007	-0.002		0.009	0.013
	(0.014)	(0.016)		(0.014)	(0.015)	(0.024)	(0.026)		(0.023)	(0.024)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
Survey-Round FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
State × Survey-Round FE	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes
District FE	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	–	No	No
Observations	32,528	32,528	.	32,525	32,387	30,448	30,448	.	30,445	30,305

D.3 Alternative Fixed Effects: Newly Formed Marriages

The following tables apply the alternative-fixed-effects exercise to the marriage-cohort design for marriages formed around the reform.

Table D9: Marriage Outcomes: Alternative Fixed Effects

	Divorced					Divorced or Separated					Age at First Cohabitation					Husband Older than 5 Years					Husband Older than 10 Years				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Muslim × Post	-0.004***	-0.004***	-0.004***	-0.004***	-0.004***	-0.003	-0.003	-0.003*	-0.003	-0.003*	0.189	0.153	0.143	-0.088	-0.106	-0.006	0.006		-0.002	0.027	0.001	0.009		0.002	0.009
	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.002)	(0.129)	(0.126)	(0.126)	(0.066)	(0.068)	(0.036)	(0.039)		(0.033)	(0.041)	(0.011)	(0.013)		(0.012)	(0.011)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
Round FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
State × Marriage-Year FE	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes
District FE	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	–	No	No
Observations	156,652	156,651	156,652	156,651	156,556	156,652	156,651	156,652	156,651	156,556	233,243	233,242	233,243	233,242	233,133	36,562	36,560	.	36,559	36,424	36,562	36,560	.	36,559	36,424

Table D10: Intimate Partner Violence Outcomes: Alternative Fixed Effects

	Wife Beating Justified				Controlling Behavior				Emotional IPV				Physical IPV				Sexual IPV			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Muslim × Post	-0.080*	-0.077	-0.078*	-0.086*	-0.111	-0.122	-0.104	-0.103	-0.047**	-0.049**	-0.042*	-0.041*	-0.005	-0.016	0.001	-0.010	0.021	0.026	0.019	0.019
	(0.041)	(0.048)	(0.041)	(0.048)	(0.081)	(0.092)	(0.079)	(0.079)	(0.022)	(0.020)	(0.022)	(0.023)	(0.042)	(0.042)	(0.046)	(0.049)	(0.018)	(0.016)	(0.020)	(0.020)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Round FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
State × Marriage-Year FE	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes
Observations	37,069	37,068	37,066	36,938	25,689	25,687	25,685	25,542	25,704	25,702	25,700	25,556	25,704	25,702	25,700	25,556	25,704	25,702	25,700	25,556

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table D11: Decision-Making Outcomes: Alternative Fixed Effects

	Own Health Care				Large Purchases				Visits to Relatives				Husband's Money				Any Decision			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Muslim × Post	0.001	0.012	-0.007	0.015	-0.014	-0.005	-0.019	-0.007	0.004	0.015	-0.006	0.002	-0.018	-0.001	-0.020	-0.006	0.030	0.042*	0.024	0.035
	(0.024)	(0.021)	(0.024)	(0.021)	(0.045)	(0.040)	(0.044)	(0.037)	(0.033)	(0.022)	(0.035)	(0.030)	(0.060)	(0.050)	(0.063)	(0.055)	(0.026)	(0.022)	(0.027)	(0.024)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Round FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
State × Marriage-Year FE	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes
Observations	35,331	35,329	35,328	35,194	35,331	35,329	35,328	35,194	35,331	35,329	35,328	35,194	35,331	35,329	35,328	35,194	35,331	35,329	35,328	35,194

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table D12: Education and Spouse Education Outcomes: Alternative Fixed Effects

	Husband More Educated					Years of Education					Completed Primary					Spouse: Primary					Spouse: Secondary					Completed Secondary				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Muslim × Post	-0.028	-0.035		-0.034	-0.038	-0.204	-0.196	-0.152	-0.265***	-0.276***	0.011	0.008	0.014*	0.009	0.006	0.029	0.017		0.024	0.017	-0.081*	-0.074		-0.091**	-0.093**	-0.026*	-0.027*	-0.022*	-0.034***	-0.030**
	(0.037)	(0.037)		(0.033)	(0.031)	(0.121)	(0.120)	(0.115)	(0.097)	(0.085)	(0.009)	(0.006)	(0.008)	(0.009)	(0.010)	(0.036)	(0.033)		(0.034)	(0.031)	(0.047)	(0.052)		(0.037)	(0.035)	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.012)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Round FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
State × Marriage-Year FE	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes
District FE	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No
Observations	36,929	36,927	.	36,926	36,796	233,005	233,004	233,005	233,004	232,895	233,005	233,004	233,005	233,004	232,895	36,967	36,966	.	36,964	36,834	36,967	36,966	.	36,964	36,834	227,582	227,582	227,582	227,581	227,480

Table D13: Employment and Occupation: Alternative Fixed Effects

	Not Working					Husband High-Skilled				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Muslim × Post	-0.021	-0.023		-0.021	-0.010	-0.049*	-0.060**		-0.056**	-0.062**
	(0.021)	(0.019)		(0.021)	(0.021)	(0.027)	(0.029)		(0.022)	(0.023)
Religion FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
Marriage-Year FE	Yes	Yes	–	No	No	Yes	Yes	–	No	No
Birth-Year FE	No	No	–	Yes	Yes	No	No	–	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
Round FE	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	–	Yes	Yes
State × Marriage-Year FE	No	Yes	–	No	No	No	Yes	–	No	No
State × Birth-Year FE	No	No	–	No	Yes	No	No	–	No	Yes
District FE	No	No	–	No	No	No	No	–	No	No
Observations	37,103	37,102	.	37,100	36,972	34,642	34,641	.	34,639	34,508

D.4 Comparison Using Pre-Reform NFHS-4 Observations

As a robustness check on the new-marriage design, we remove marriages formed before the reform but observed in NFHS-5 from the comparison group. The pre-reform comparison group consists only of NFHS-4 respondents whose first cohabitation occurred between January 2012 and August 2018, while the post-period consists of NFHS-5 respondents whose first cohabitation occurred in September 2018 or later. Each table reports the coefficient on $Muslim_i \times Post$. All specifications include religion, state, marriage-year, state × marriage-year, and survey-wave fixed effects. The intimate-partner-violence and decision-making specifications additionally include years-since-marriage fixed effects, matching the corresponding main specifications. Regressions use the appropriate NFHS weights, and standard errors are clustered at the state level.

Table D14: Pre-Reform NFHS-4 Comparison: Marriage Outcomes

	(1) Age at First Cohabitation	(2) Age Gap ≥ 5 Years	(3) Age Gap ≥ 10 Years
Muslim × Post	-0.013	0.038	0.028
	(0.155)	(0.042)	(0.017)
Non-Muslim (Pre)	20.387	0.414	0.087
Non-Muslim (Post)	21.262	0.374	0.070
Muslim (Pre)	20.130	0.420	0.069
Observations	104,139	17,525	17,525

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table D15: Pre-Reform NFHS-4 Comparison: Intimate Partner Violence

	(1) Wife Beating Justified	(2) Husband Controlling	(3) Emotional IPV	(4) Physical IPV	(5) Sexual IPV
Muslim × Post	-0.080*	-0.110	-0.057**	-0.010	0.044***
	(0.044)	(0.109)	(0.024)	(0.034)	(0.015)
Non-Muslim (Pre)	0.407	0.490	0.084	0.159	0.044
Non-Muslim (Post)	0.348	0.473	0.065	0.114	0.025
Muslim (Pre)	0.450	0.475	0.083	0.144	0.035
Observations	17,555	11,161	11,167	11,167	11,167

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table D16: Pre-Reform NFHS-4 Comparison: Decision-Making

	(1) Healthcare	(2) Large Purchases	(3) Relatives	(4) Husband's Money	(5) Any Decision
Muslim × Post	0.004	-0.015	-0.006	-0.031	0.043*
	(0.022)	(0.041)	(0.026)	(0.049)	(0.021)
Non-Muslim (Pre)	0.694	0.653	0.683	0.641	0.813
Non-Muslim (Post)	0.729	0.699	0.734	0.694	0.845
Muslim (Pre)	0.687	0.643	0.672	0.619	0.789
Observations	16,803	16,803	16,803	16,803	16,803

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table D17: Pre-Reform NFHS-4 Comparison: Women's Characteristics

	(1) Years of Education	(2) Primary Completed	(3) Secondary Completed
Muslim × Post	-0.181	0.014**	-0.037***
	(0.113)	(0.006)	(0.013)
Non-Muslim (Pre)	9.320	0.852	0.380
Non-Muslim (Post)	10.600	0.918	0.502
Muslim (Pre)	7.755	0.772	0.253
Observations	103,934	103,934	99,392

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table D18: Pre-Reform NFHS-4 Comparison: Spouse Characteristics

	(1) Not Working	(2) Husband High-Skilled	(3) Spouse: Primary	(4) Spouse: Secondary
Muslim × Post	0.007	-0.066*	0.006	-0.058
	(0.017)	(0.037)	(0.037)	(0.055)
Non-Muslim (Pre)	0.888	0.176	0.890	0.401
Non-Muslim (Post)	0.876	0.182	0.925	0.501
Muslim (Pre)	0.929	0.152	0.781	0.248
Observations	17,576	16,259	17,517	17,517

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

D.5 Men's Employment and Earnings

Table D19: Men's Employment and Earnings: Rural and Urban India

	(1) Employment	(2) Log monthly salaried earnings	(3) Log daily casual earnings
Muslim × Post	−0.003	0.018	−0.013
	(0.004)	(0.030)	(0.013)
Non-Muslim (Pre)	0.911	17,222	284
Non-Muslim (Post)	0.902	18,604	323
Muslim (Pre)	0.913	13,353	299
Observations	504,535	176,373	65,747

Notes: The sample consists of men aged 25–54 of all marital statuses in the PLFS from July 2017 through June 2020. Rural observations comprise first visits; urban observations include first visits and revisits. Observations are person-visits, so urban respondents may appear in multiple quarters. July–September 2018 is excluded because it includes both pre- and post-reform months. Post equals one from October–December 2018 onward.
Employment is an indicator based on current weekly status, referring to the preceding seven days. Column (2) uses log positive earnings in the preceding calendar month among regular salaried workers. Column (3) uses log positive earnings per paid day among casual workers outside public works. Earnings means are reported in nominal rupees, before taking logs; employment means are proportions. Means use the corresponding estimation samples.
All specifications include state, calendar-quarter, state × calendar-quarter, religion, single-year age, and rural–urban fixed effects. Calendar quarters distinguish both quarter and year. Regressions use survey weights adjusted for the quarterly sampling design. Standard errors, reported in parentheses, are clustered at the state level.

E Statistical Inference

E.1 Wild-Cluster Bootstrap Inference

The tables report conventional state-clustered and wild-cluster-bootstrap p-values for the baseline specifications, first for pre-reform marriages and then for newly formed marriages.

Table E1: Wild-Cluster Bootstrap Inference: Pre-Reform Marriages

	Coef.	Conventional p	Wild-bootstrap p
Divorce			
Divorced (pp)	-0.082	0.060	0.112
Divorced or Separated (pp)	-0.060	0.457	0.473
Marriage			
Age at First Cohabitation	-0.300	0.004	0.035
Age Gap $\geq$ 5 Years	0.057	0.001	0.008
Age Gap $\geq$ 10 Years	0.019	0.095	0.108
Intimate Partner Violence			
Wife Beating Justified	0.001	0.957	0.896
Husband Controlling	0.018	0.585	0.596
Emotional IPV	-0.011	0.453	0.550
Physical IPV	0.001	0.958	0.954
Sexual IPV	0.022	0.295	0.423
Women's Own Characteristics			
Years of Education	0.005	0.937	0.919
Primary Completed	0.010	0.036	0.054
Secondary Completed	-0.020	0.039	0.031
Not Working	0.053	0.002	0.000
Spouse Characteristics			
Husband High-Skilled	-0.002	0.937	0.892
Spouse: Primary	-0.008	0.525	0.519
Spouse: Secondary	0.009	0.686	0.731
Decision-Making			
Healthcare	-0.019	0.323	0.254
Large Purchases	-0.024	0.189	0.165
Relatives	-0.032	0.163	0.162
Husband's Money	-0.052	0.004	0.004
Any Decision	-0.003	0.862	0.838

Notes: Primary completion requires first cohabitation at age 12 or older; secondary completion requires first cohabitation at age 18 or older, as in Table 2, Panel B.

Table 5 reports wild-cluster-bootstrap p-values for the quarterly first-marriage hazard

estimates by age and primary completion in Panels B and C. Among girls aged 12–17 without primary completion, the p-value for the Muslim × Post coefficient is 0.038. The bootstrap uses the same NFHS-5 weighted specifications and state clusters as the main estimates, with 520 replications.

Table E2: Wild-Cluster Bootstrap Inference: Newly Formed Marriages

	Coef.	Conventional p	Wild-bootstrap p
Divorce and Marriage			
Divorced	-0.004	0.005	< 0.002
Divorced or Separated	-0.003	0.152	0.158
Age at First Cohabitation	0.153	0.231	0.342
Age Gap $\geq$ 5 Years	0.006	0.879	0.915
Age Gap $\geq$ 10 Years	0.009	0.480	0.546
Intimate Partner Violence			
Wife Beating Justified	-0.077	0.114	0.223
Husband Controlling	-0.122	0.195	0.335
Emotional IPV	-0.049	0.019	0.158
Physical IPV	-0.016	0.711	0.785
Sexual IPV	0.026	0.113	0.154
Women's Own Characteristics			
Years of Education	-0.196	0.112	0.327
Primary Completed	0.008	0.216	0.150
Secondary Completed	-0.027	0.051	0.204
Not Working	-0.023	0.239	0.215
Spouse Characteristics			
Husband High-Skilled	-0.060	0.046	0.138
Spouse: Primary	0.017	0.613	0.781
Spouse: Secondary	-0.074	0.161	0.381
Decision-Making			
Healthcare	0.012	0.563	0.546
Large Purchases	-0.005	0.912	0.935
Relatives	0.015	0.486	0.569
Husband's Money	-0.001	0.990	0.985
Any Decision	0.042	0.069	0.065

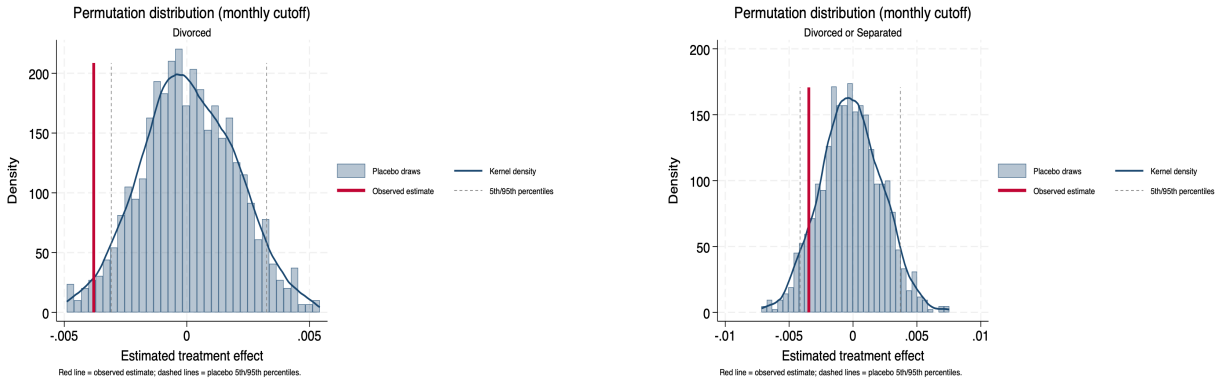
Notes: Each row is a separate DiD regression of the outcome on Muslim × Post, post defined by marriage on/after September 2018. IPV and decision-making outcomes add years-since-marriage fixed effects; marriage, own, and spouse characteristics use the baseline marriage-cohort fixed effects (religion, marriage-year, state, state × marriage-year, survey round). Divorce outcomes use NFHS-5 only. Wild-cluster-bootstrap p-values use 520 replications, clustered on 35 states.

E.2 Multiple-Testing Adjustments

The main tables also report Holm-adjusted p-values based on conventional state-clustered p-values. The step-down correction is applied separately within each design and outcome family: the three age and age-gap outcomes, the four women's schooling and employment outcomes, the four individual household decisions, and the three intimate-partner-violence outcomes. Participation in any decision is reported separately as a summary outcome and is excluded from the multiple-testing family. These adjustments leave the estimated coefficients unchanged.

E.3 Permutation Tests

The permutation-based randomization-inference exercise applies only to the main monthly new-marriage-cohort analysis. In that design, treatment status is defined by the month of first cohabitation, so placebo reform timing can be assigned across marriage months while holding fixed the number of post-reform months. The exercise is not applied to the pre-reform married-stock or full-sample ever-married analyses, for which the post indicator is defined by NFHS survey round and only two rounds are available. The figures below report selected outcomes from the marital-exit block (divorce and divorce or separation), the marital-quality block (wife-beating attitudes, husbands' controlling behavior, and emotional IPV), decision-making (any decision), women's and spouses' education, and employment and occupation. Each exercise uses 1,000 placebo assignments, holding the sample, controls, and fixed effects unchanged.

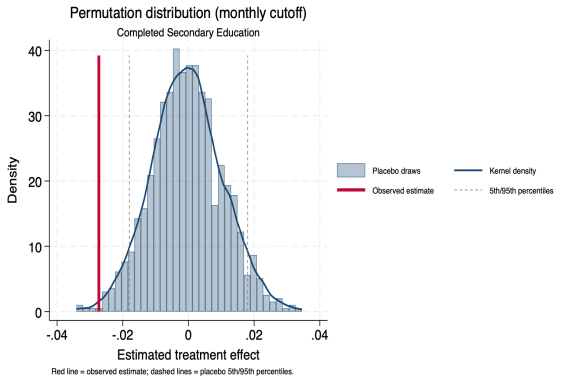


(a) Divorced

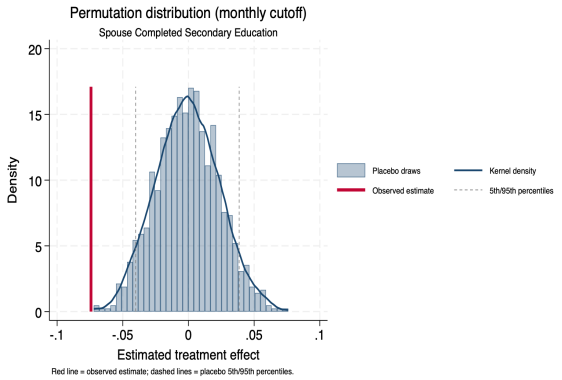
(b) Divorced or Separated

Figure E1: Permutation Tests: Marriage Outcomes

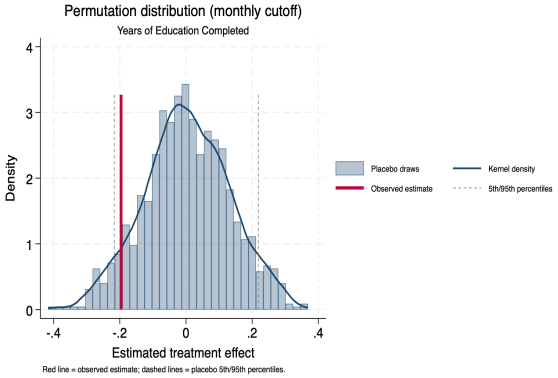
Figure E2: Permutation Tests: Education Outcomes



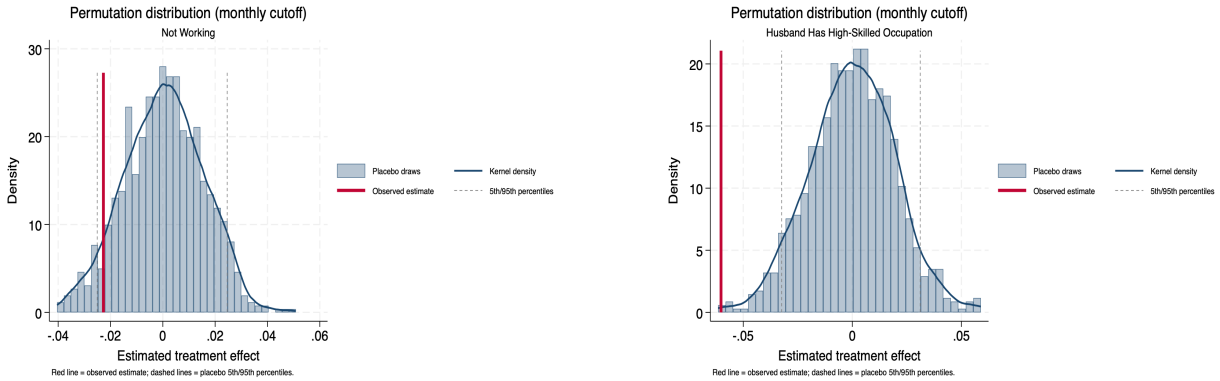
(a) Secondary Completed



(b) Spouse Completed Secondary Education



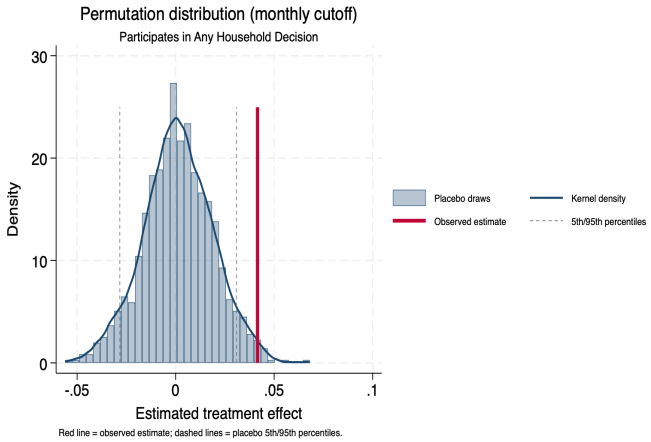
(c) Years of Education Completed



(a) Women Not Working

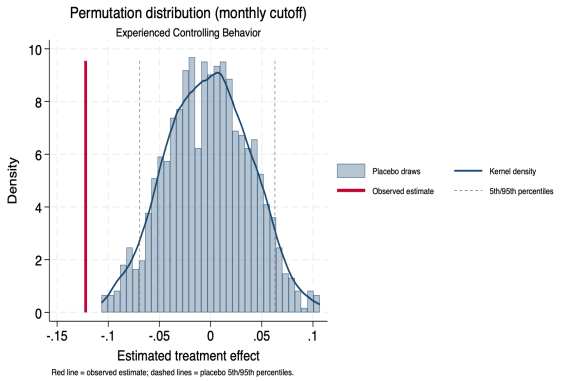
(b) Husband Occupation High Skilled

Figure E3: Permutation Tests: Employment and Occupation

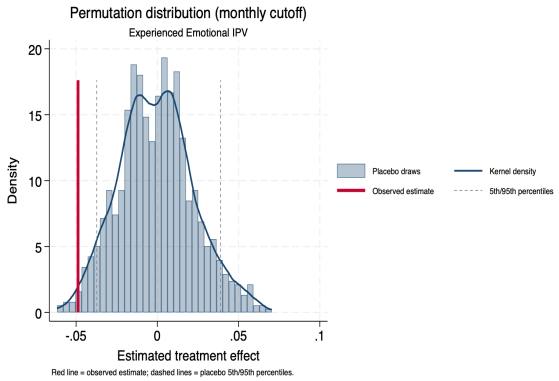


(a) Any Decision

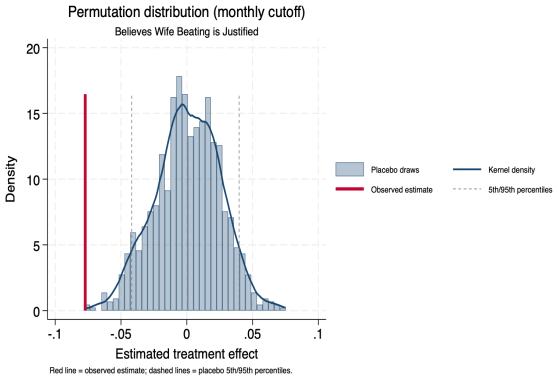
Figure E4: Permutation Tests: Decision-Making Outcomes



(a) Husband Controlling



(b) Emotional IPV



(c) Wife Beating Justified in Any Situation

Figure E5: Permutation Tests: Emotional Violence, Attitudes, and Controlling Behavior

F Conceptual Framework Derivations

F.1 Bilateral Participation and Marriage Entry

We use a simple future-exit decision to relate the option value to the payoffs in the main text. Fix z and let ε be a mean-zero future change in the husband's payoff from staying married. Its distribution conditional on z is held fixed as F and q change. It represents uncertainty about future marriage payoffs. Assume there is no probability mass exactly at the point of indifference between staying and leaving.

Let $\delta \in (0,1)$ be a fixed weight on the future decision, with the weights on the earlier and future payoffs normalized to sum to one. Before that decision, the husband receives $u_h + J_h$. At the future decision, he chooses between staying, with value $u_h + J_h + \varepsilon$, and leaving, with value $A_h - F$. Suppressing functional arguments within the expectation, the value of marriage is

$$\begin{aligned} V_h(q,z,F) &= (1-\delta)(u_h + J_h) + \delta \mathbb{E}\left[\max\{u_h + J_h + \varepsilon, A_h - F\} \mid z\right] \\ &= u_h(q,z) + J_h(q,F) + \Omega(q,z,F), \end{aligned}$$

where, writing $(x)_+ = \max\{x, 0\}$,

$$\Omega(q,z,F) = \delta \mathbb{E}\left[(A_h(z) - F - u_h(q,z) - J_h(q,F) - \varepsilon)_+ \mid z\right].$$

The second equality uses $\mathbb{E}[\varepsilon \mid z] = 0$. Thus, Ω is the additional value of the future exit choice relative to staying. The outside payoff enters through A_h, while the payoff from staying enters through $u_h + J_h + \varepsilon$.

The probability of future exit is

$$p(q,z,F) = \Pr\left(A_h(z) - F > u_h(q,z) + J_h(q,F) + \varepsilon \mid z\right).$$

Holding A_h and the shock distribution fixed, the advantage of future exit changes with F by $-(1 + J_{hF})$. Differentiating the option value gives

$$\Omega_F(q, z, F) = -\delta p(q, z, F)(1 + J_{hF}).$$

The direct increase in exit friction reduces the option's value, while a decline in the payoff from staying makes it more useful. There is no additional boundary term because the option payoff is zero at indifference. Using $\Delta_j = V_j - A_j$, the surplus responses are

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta_{wF} &= J_{wF} + B'(F),\\ \Delta_{hF} &= J_{hF} + \Omega_F = (1 - \delta p)J_{hF} - \delta p.\end{aligned}$$

The assumption $J_{wF} + B'(F) \geq 0$ makes the woman's net response nonnegative without requiring $J_{wF} \geq 0$. The husband's response remains ambiguous. It is negative whenever $J_{hF} < 0$.

To support the match-quality assumption in the main text, suppose $u_{jq} + J_{jq} > 0$ for both spouses, holding z and F fixed. Subscripts q denote derivatives with respect to match quality. Since higher q raises the payoff from staying without changing the outside value or the shock distribution,

$$\Omega_q = -\delta p(u_{hq} + J_{hq}).$$

It follows that

$$\begin{aligned}V_{wq} &= u_{wq} + J_{wq} > 0,\\ V_{hq} &= (1 - \delta p)(u_{hq} + J_{hq}) > 0,\end{aligned}$$

because B does not depend on q and $1 - \delta p > 0$. With $A_j(z)$ fixed, $\Delta_{jq} = V_{jq} > 0$ as well.

Let $q_j(F, z)$ be an interior cutoff solving $\Delta_j(q_j, z, F) = 0$ for $j \in \{w, h\}$. The implicit-function theorem gives

$$\frac{\partial q_j(F, z)}{\partial F} = -\frac{\partial \Delta_j(q, z, F)/\partial F}{\partial \Delta_j(q, z, F)/\partial q}.$$

The derivatives are evaluated at each spouse's cutoff. Under the woman's net-benefit assumption, $\partial \Delta_w / \partial F \geq 0$ and her cutoff does not rise. The husband's cutoff rises when his surplus falls and falls when his surplus rises. The effective cutoff is $q^*(F, z) = \max\{q_w(F, z), q_h(F, z)\}$, so either partner's participation constraint can bind.

With $m_{az}(F)$ denoting the arrival rate of potential matches and Φ_{az} and ϕ_{az} denoting a fixed distribution and density of offered match quality, the age-specific marriage hazard is

$$\lambda_{az}(F) = m_{az}(F) \left[1 - \Phi_{az}\big(q^*(F, z)\big)\right].$$

Where q^* is differentiable, the hazard derivative is

$$\frac{d\lambda_{az}(F)}{dF} = \frac{\partial m_{az}(F)}{\partial F} \left[1 - \Phi_{az}\big(q^*(F, z)\big)\right] - m_{az}(F)\phi_{az}\big(q^*(F, z)\big)\frac{\partial q^*(F, z)}{\partial F}.$$

The sign is therefore ambiguous even if match opportunities are unchanged, and it can differ across types z or ages a. With outside values, match arrivals, and offered quality fixed, a decline requires q^* to rise. Since the woman's cutoff does not rise under the net-benefit assumption, such an increase must come from the husband. At a point where the two cutoffs coincide, the same comparison applies using one-sided changes.

For a fixed age a, type z, and distribution of offered matches, let

$$\bar{q}^N_{az}(F) = \mathbb{E}\left[q \mid q \geq q^*(F, z)\right].$$

Differentiating with respect to the joint cutoff gives

$$\frac{\partial \bar{q}^N_{az}(F)}{\partial q^*} = \frac{\phi_{az}(q^*)}{1 - \Phi_{az}(q^*)} \left[\bar{q}^N_{az}(F) - q^*(F, z)\right] \geq 0.$$

Therefore, a cutoff-driven decline in entry raises average q among the marriages formed within that type. A decline caused by a lower arrival rate does not imply this change.

F.2 Exit and Survivor Selection

For an existing marriage, continuation surplus is

$$S(q, z, F) = V_h(q, z, F) - [A_h(z) - F].$$

Using $S = \Delta_h + F$ and the surplus derivative above,

$$S_F(q, z, F) = 1 + \Delta_{hF}(q, z, F) = (1 - \delta p(q, z, F))(1 + J_{hF}).$$

Because $1 - \delta p > 0$, $S_F \geq 0$ if and only if $J_{hF} \geq -1$. This is the continuation condition used in the main text. It permits a decline in the husband's within-marriage payoff, provided the decline does not outweigh the higher exit friction in the comparison between staying and leaving. If $J_{hF} < -1$, continuation surplus falls instead. The advantage of future exit also changes by $-(1 + J_{hF})$, so the same condition makes p weakly fall for a given match under the fixed shock distribution.

The match-quality result above implies $S_q = V_{hq} > 0$. Let $q^S(F, z)$ be an interior cutoff solving $S(q^S, z, F) = 0$. Under the continuation condition, the implicit-function theorem gives

$$\frac{\partial q^S(F, z)}{\partial F} = -\frac{S_F(q, z, F)}{S_q(q, z, F)} \leq 0.$$

Hence, the reform weakly lowers the match-quality cutoff for remaining in the observed married stock. The pre- and post-reform cutoff comparisons use the stated conditions over the interval from F_0 to F_1. When the cutoff falls, the newly retained marriages have lower q than those that would have remained observed under the old regime, conditional on z.

For a fixed type z, let Ψ_z and ψ_z denote the distribution and density of q among existing marriages, and write $c(F, z) = q^S(F, z)$. The average observed outcome among surviving

marriages of type z is

$$\bar{Y}^S(F,z) = \frac{\displaystyle\int_{c(F,z)}^{\infty} y(q,F,z)\psi_z(q)\,dq}{1-\Psi_z(c(F,z))}.$$

Differentiating gives

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{d\bar{Y}^S(F,z)}{dF} &= \mathbb{E}\left[y_F(q,F,z) \mid q \geq c(F,z)\right] \\ &\quad + \frac{\psi_z(c)}{1-\Psi_z(c)}\frac{\partial c(F,z)}{\partial F}\left[\bar{Y}^S(F,z) - y(c,F,z)\right].\end{aligned}$$

The first term is the within-marriage effect. The second is the survivor-selection effect. Under the continuation condition, $c_F \leq 0$, so the selection term is nonpositive for an outcome that is lower at the cutoff than among marriages already in the surviving stock. It is negative when the cutoff falls and there is positive density at the margin. For a characteristic fixed when the marriage formed, $y_F(q,F,z) = 0$, so its change conditional on z is entirely compositional. The unconditional mean in the main text also permits differential survival to change the distribution of z; that reweighting is part of survivor selection. The decomposition remains valid if the continuation condition fails, but the direction of selection can reverse.

F.3 Outcomes among New Marriages

Let P_r^N denote the joint distribution of (q,z) among marriages formed under regime r, and write $y_r(q,z) = y(q,F_r,z)$. The average outcome in the new-marriage cohort is

$$\bar{Y}_r^N = \int y_r(q,z)\,dP_r^N(q,z).$$

Adding and subtracting the outcome under the post-reform law evaluated over the pre-reform distribution gives the exact decomposition

$$\bar{Y}_1^N - \bar{Y}_0^N = \underbrace{\int [y_1(q,z) - y_0(q,z)]\, dP_0^N(q,z)}_{\text{within-marriage effect}} + \underbrace{\left[\int y_1(q,z) dP_1^N(q,z) - \int y_1(q,z) dP_0^N(q,z)\right]}_{\text{entry-selection effect}}.$$

The first term holds the pre-reform set of matches fixed and changes the legal regime. The second holds post-reform outcomes fixed and changes the joint distribution of latent match quality and observed characteristics among the marriages that form. For a characteristic fixed at entry, the first term is zero. For divorce, intimate partner violence, and decision-making, both terms can contribute. For a given match, the continuation condition $J_{hF} \geq -1$ weakly reduces the probability of future exit through the affected route; entry selection may reinforce or offset this effect. This condition matters even when the match is fixed because its within-marriage payoffs can change with F. The framework does not impose a sign on the within-marriage effects on intimate partner violence or decision-making.

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